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# (12) United States Patent
Walker

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(45) Date of Patent: *Sep. 9, 2025

(54) **SELECTIVELY SECURABLE COVER**

(71) Applicant: **Modus Light, LLC**, Overland Park, KS (US)

(72) Inventor: **Joshua Drew Walker**, Kansas City, MO (US)

(73) Assignee: **MODUS LIGHT, LLC**, Overland Park, KS (US)

( * ) Notice: Subject to any disclaimer, the term of this patent is extended or adjusted under 35 U.S.C. 154(b) by 19 days.

This patent is subject to a terminal disclaimer.

(21) Appl. No.: **18/417,041**

(22) Filed: **Jan. 19, 2024**

(65) **Prior Publication Data**

US 2024/0148185 A1 May 9, 2024

**Related U.S. Application Data**

(63) Continuation-in-part of application No. 18/172,004, filed on Feb. 21, 2023, now Pat. No. 11,882,963, which is a continuation of application No. 16/881,075, filed on May 22, 2020, now Pat. No. 11,583,142.

(51) **Int. Cl.**
***A47J 37/07*** (2006.01)
***F16B 5/06*** (2006.01)

(52) **U.S. Cl.**
CPC ......... ***A47J 37/0786*** (2013.01); ***F16B 5/0607*** (2013.01); *F16B 2200/83* (2023.08)

(58) **Field of Classification Search**
CPC ... A46G 27/0206; A47J 37/0786; B41J 29/13; F24F 1/58; F24F 13/20
USPC .................................... 108/90; 150/165, 154
See application file for complete search history.

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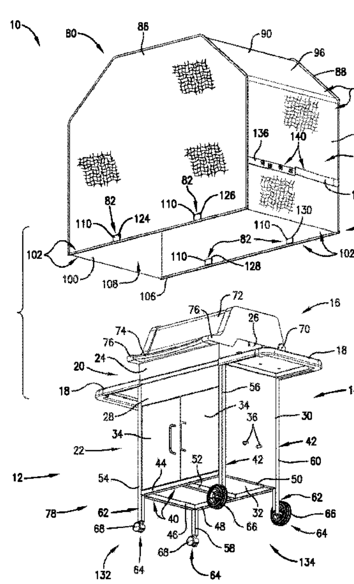
*Primary Examiner* — Jose V Chen
(74) *Attorney, Agent, or Firm* — Husch Blackwell LLP

(57) **ABSTRACT**

An outdoor equipment cover is configured to be utilized with outdoor equipment having a metallic component, the outdoor equipment cover includes a cover body, a magnetic fastener, and a secondary fastener. The cover body presents an outer edge disposed along a bottom side and a cover void therein configured to receive the outdoor equipment therein. The magnetic fastener and the secondary fastener are each secured to the cover body. The magnetic fastener is configured to provide a magnetic force to keep the magnetic fastener selectively secured to the metallic component of the outdoor equipment so as to keep the cover body in place around the outdoor equipment therein. The secondary fastener is configured to reduce a cross-sectional area of the cover void so as to prevent the outdoor equipment cover from being removed from the outdoor equipment while the secondary fastener is emplaced.

**19 Claims, 33 Drawing Sheets**



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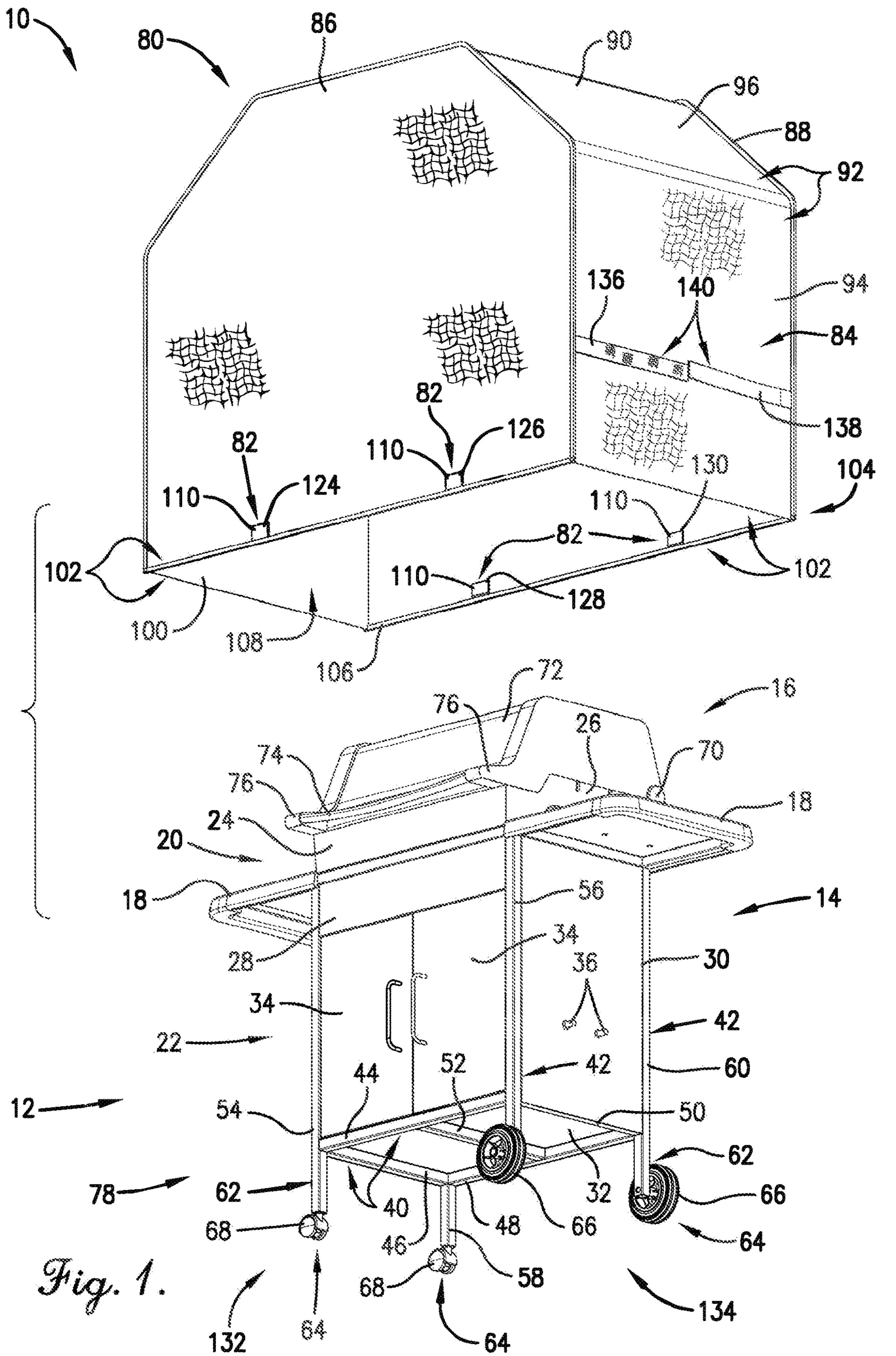
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Fig. 1.

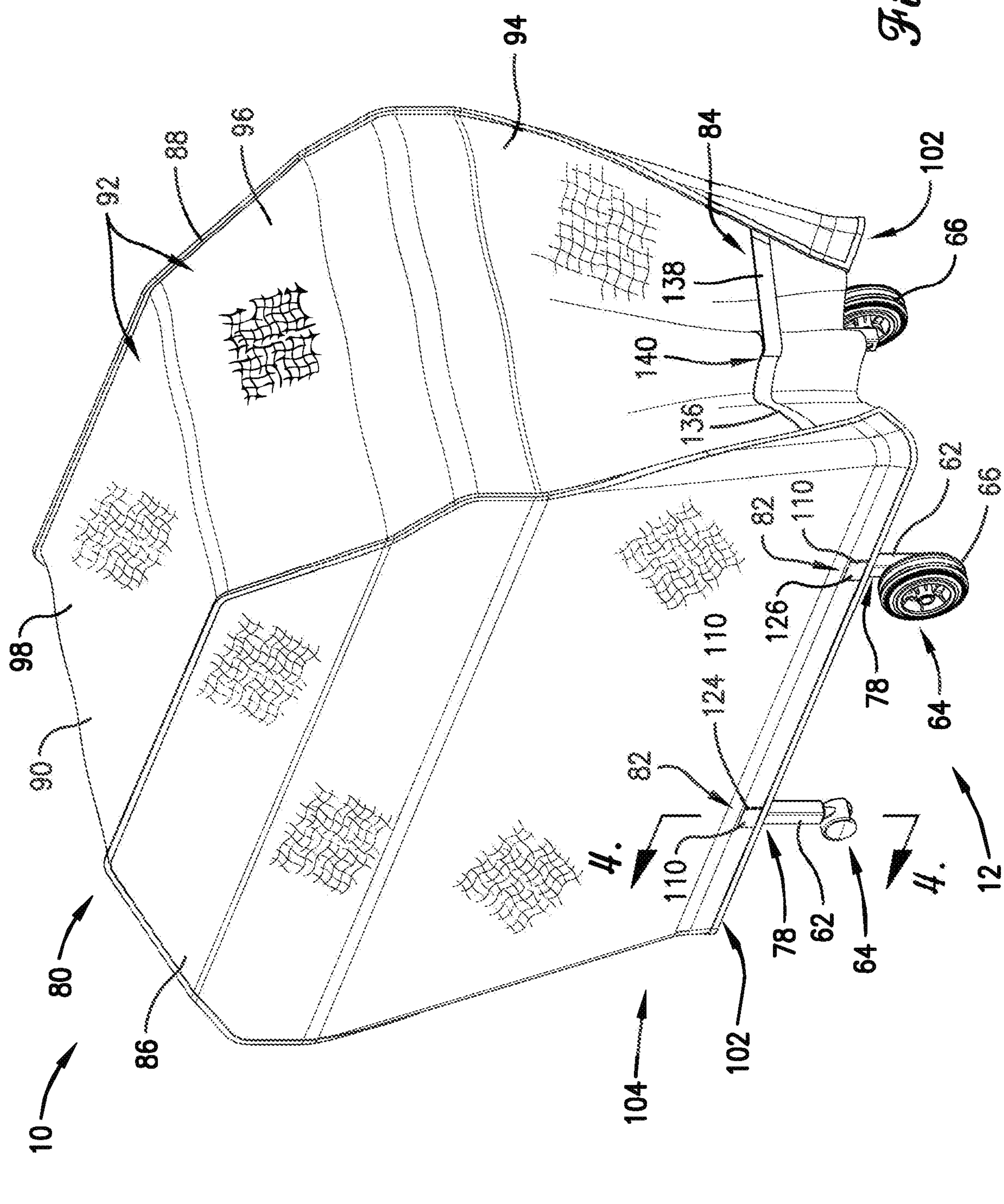
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Fig. 2.

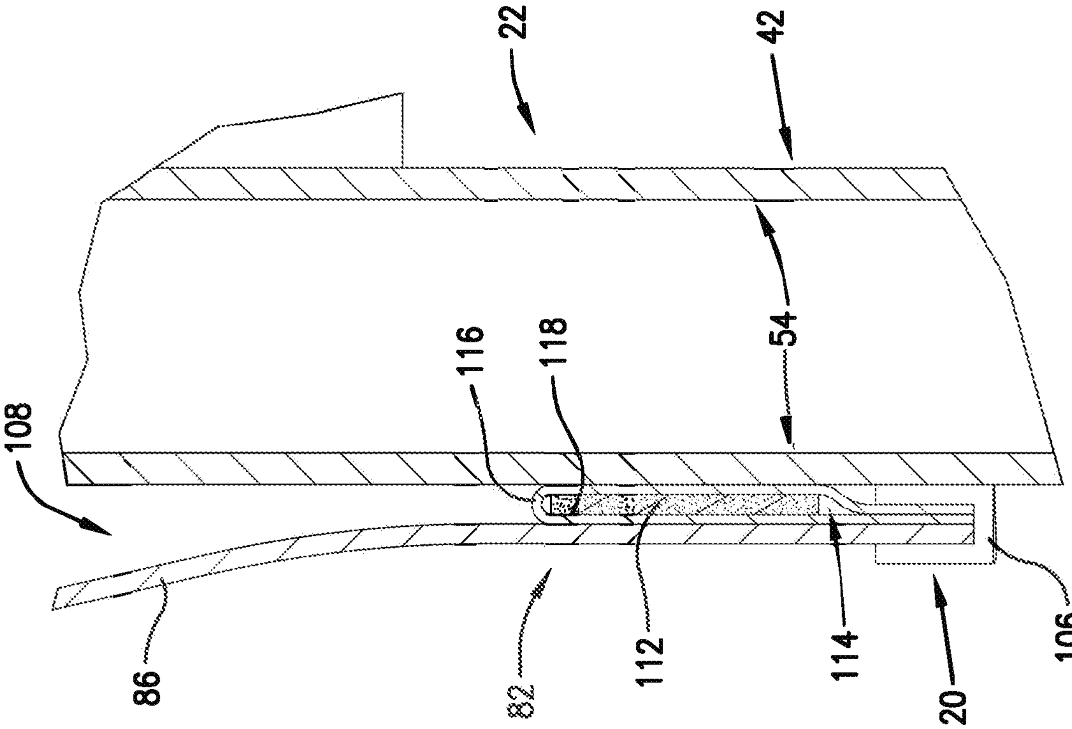
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Fig. 4.

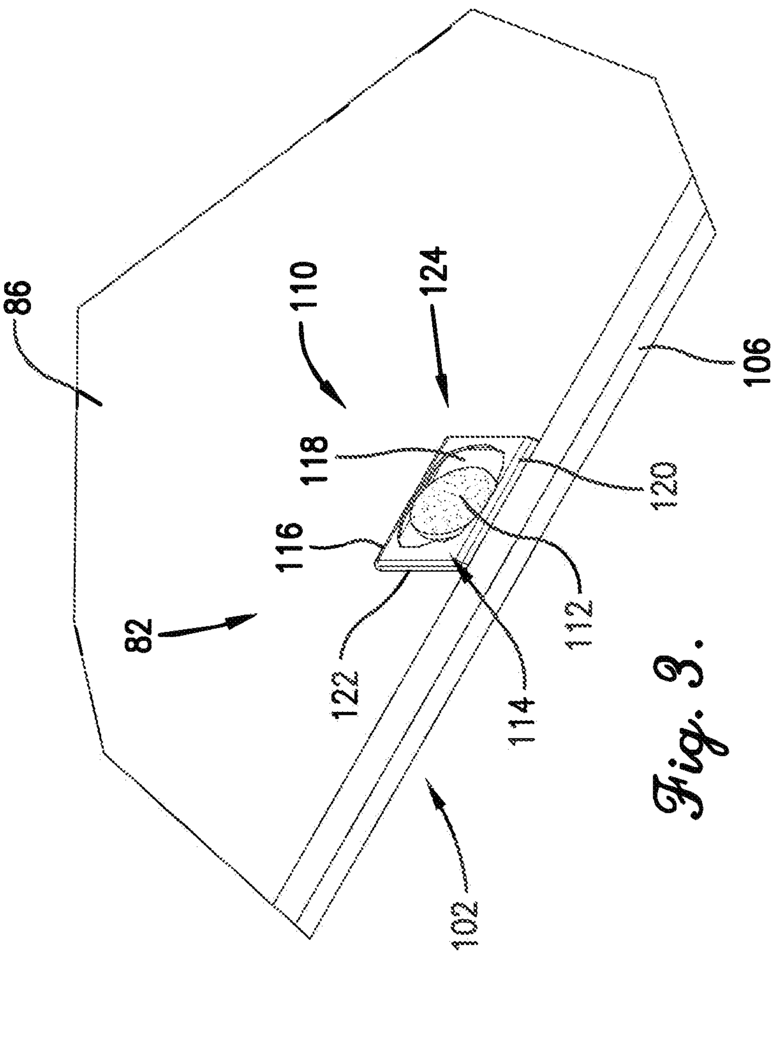
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Fig. 3.

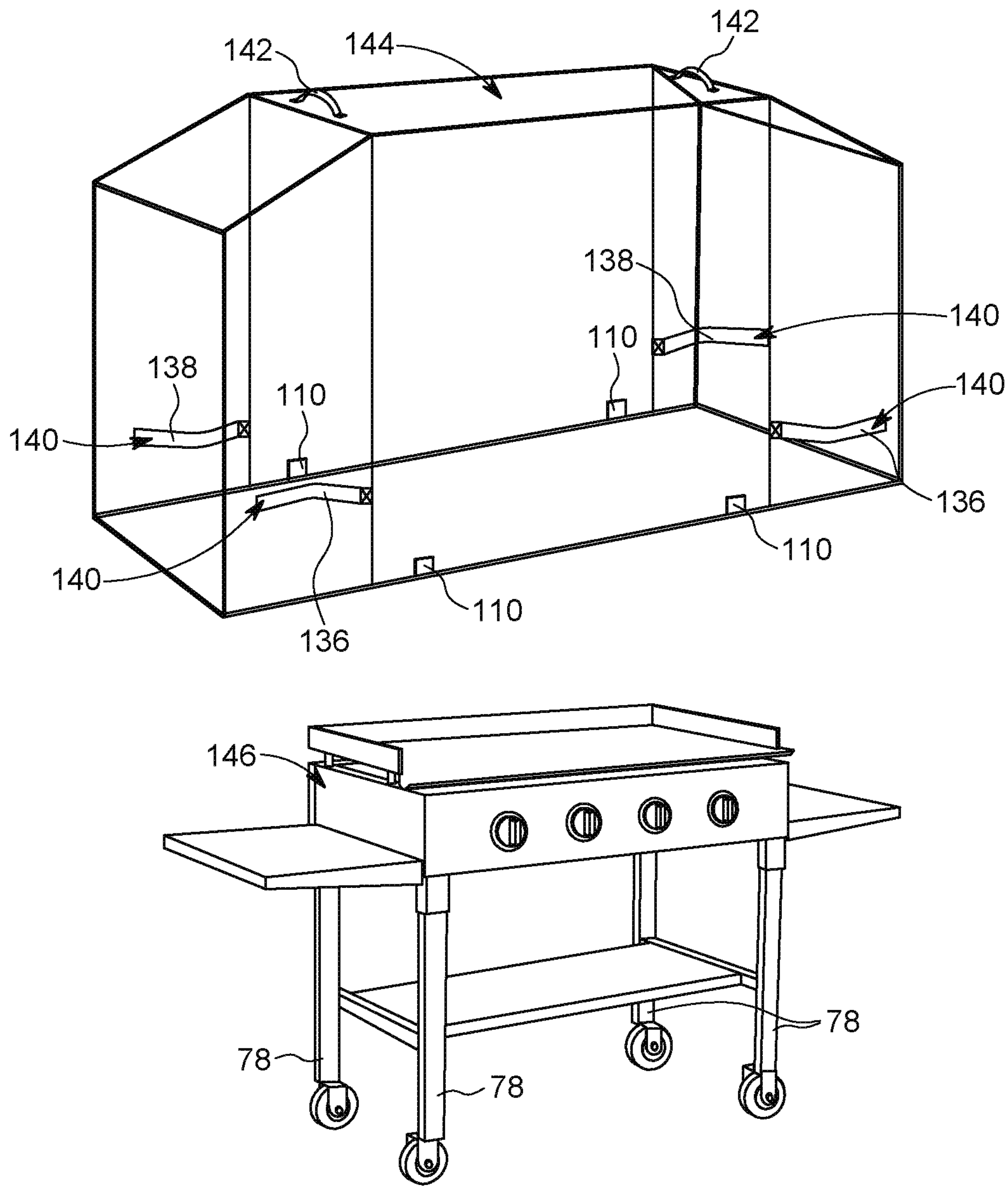
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FIG. 5

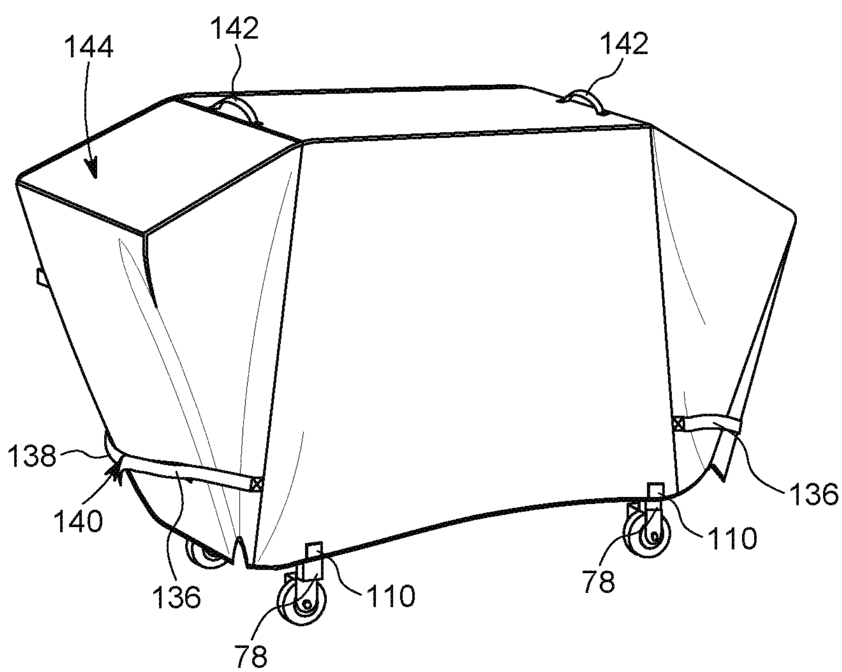



FIG. 6

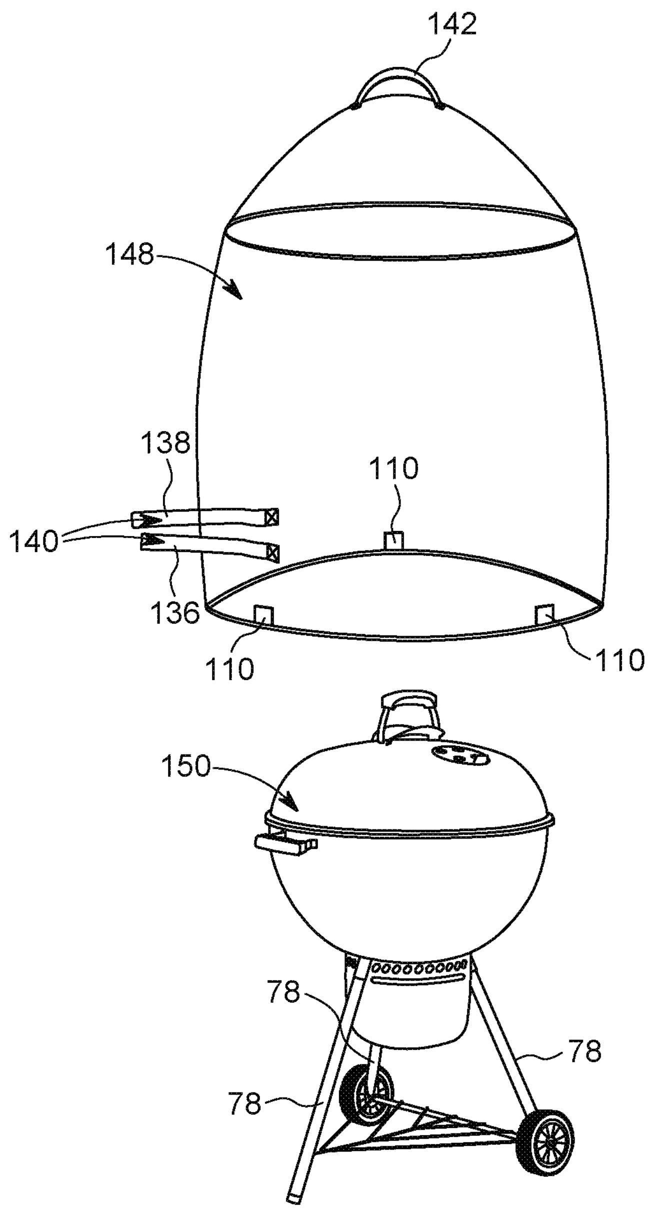



FIG. 7

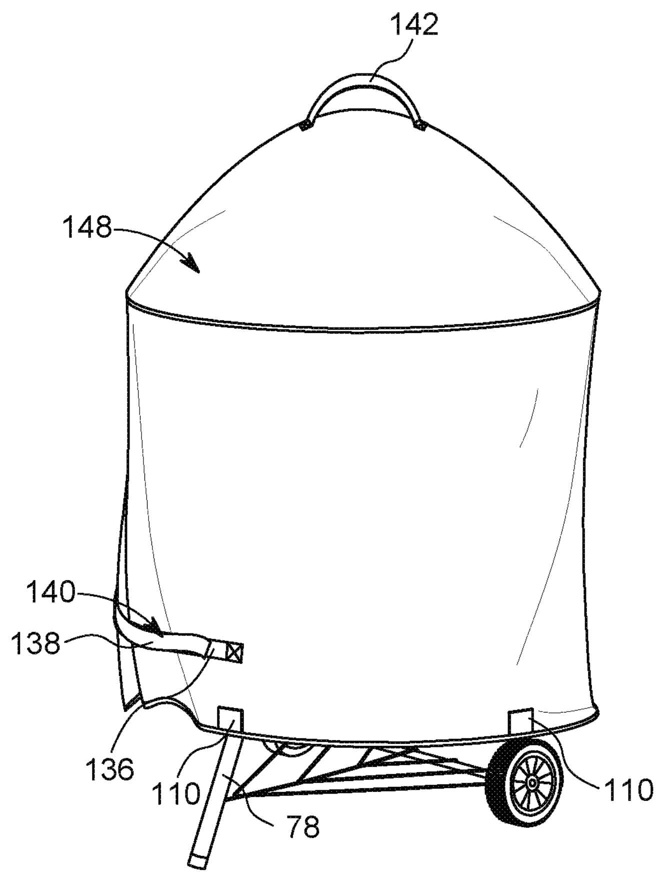



FIG. 8

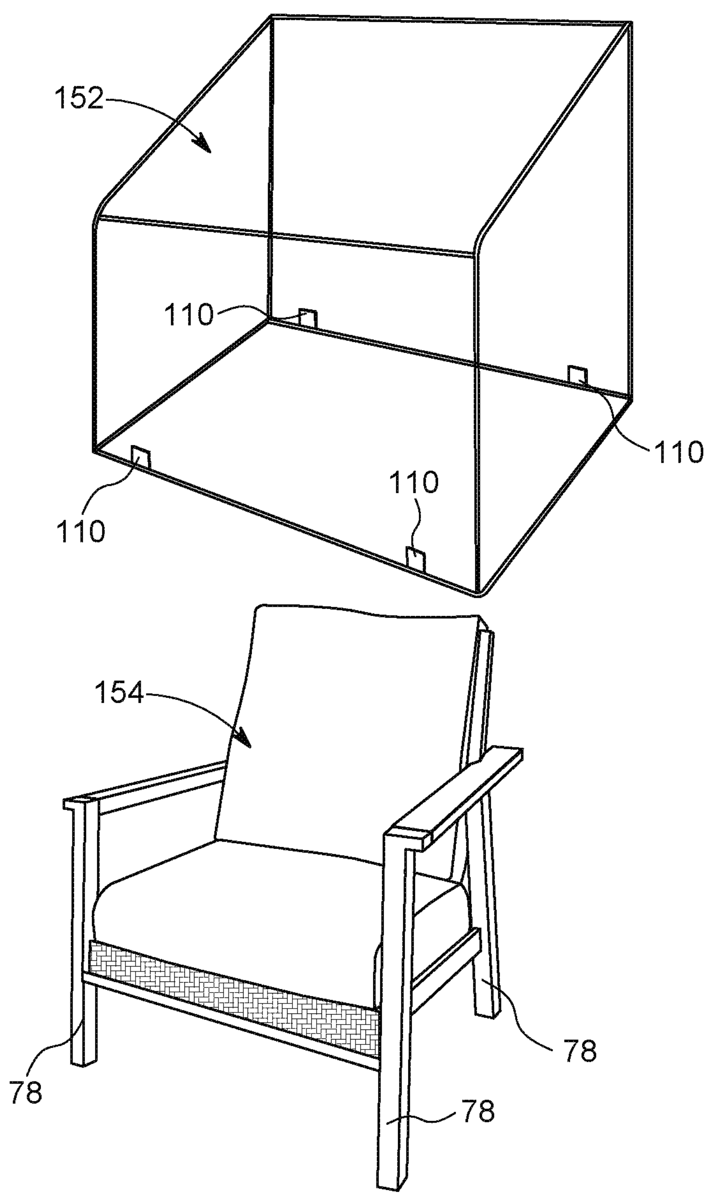
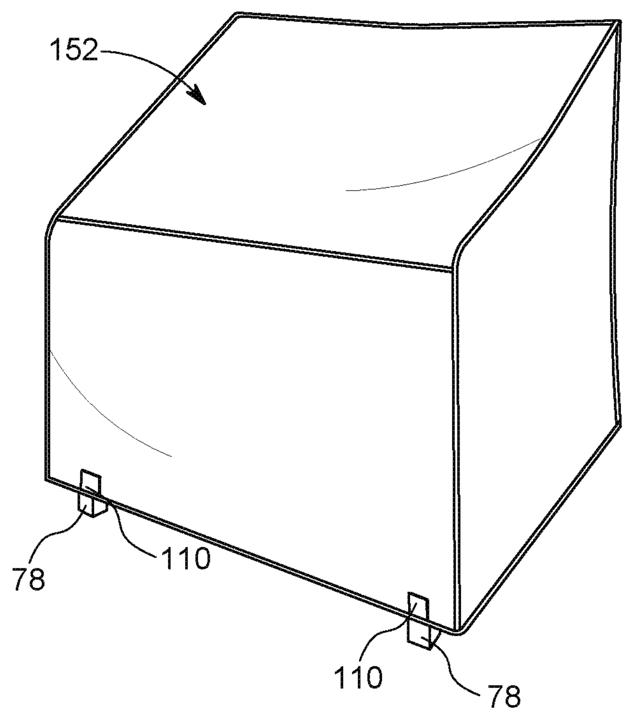



FIG. 9

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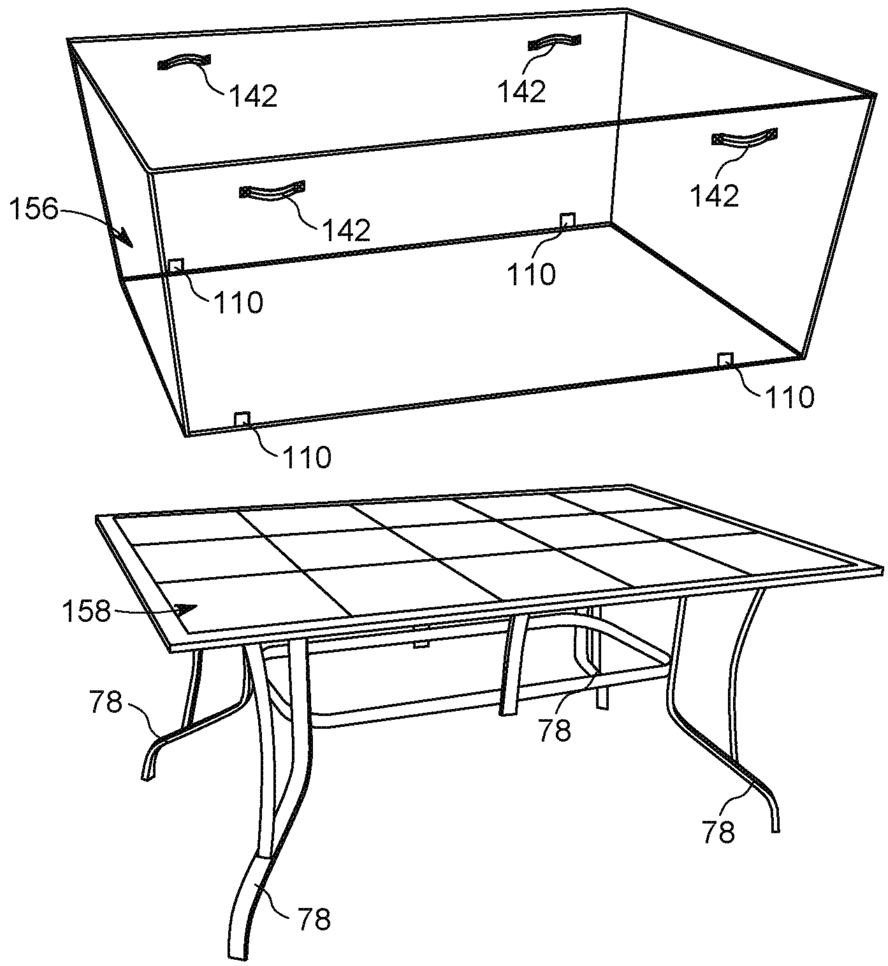


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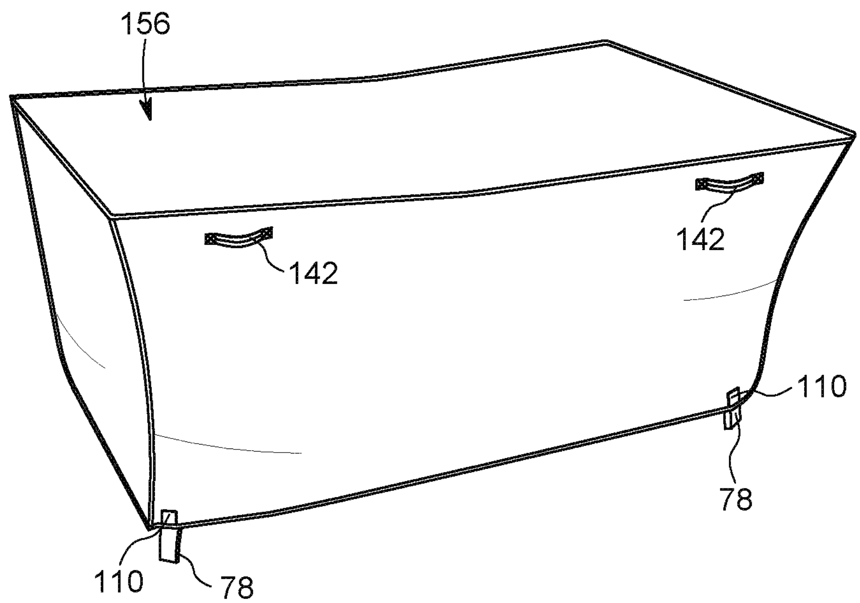


FIG. 12

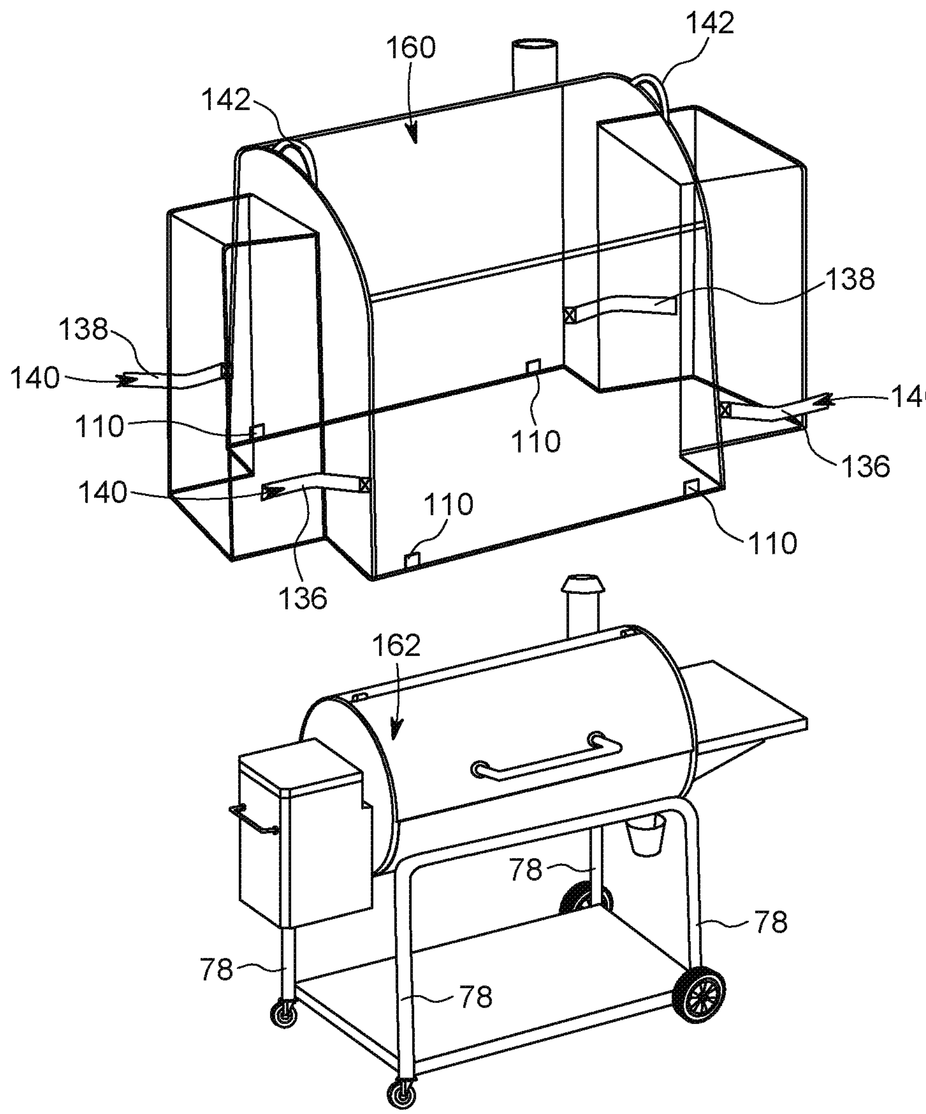
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FIG. 13

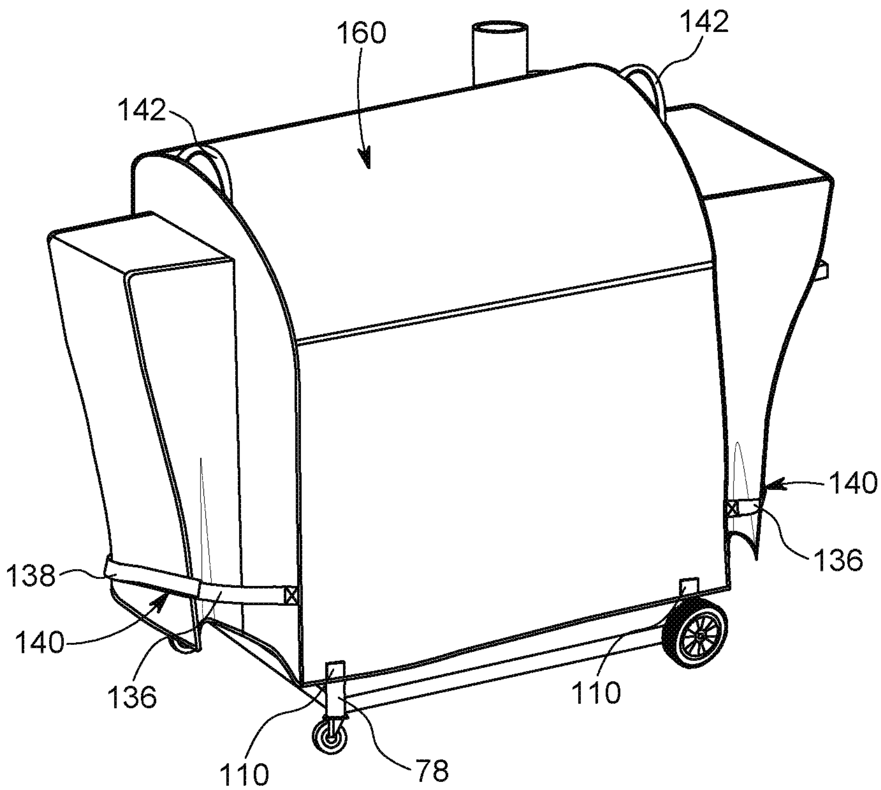



FIG. 14

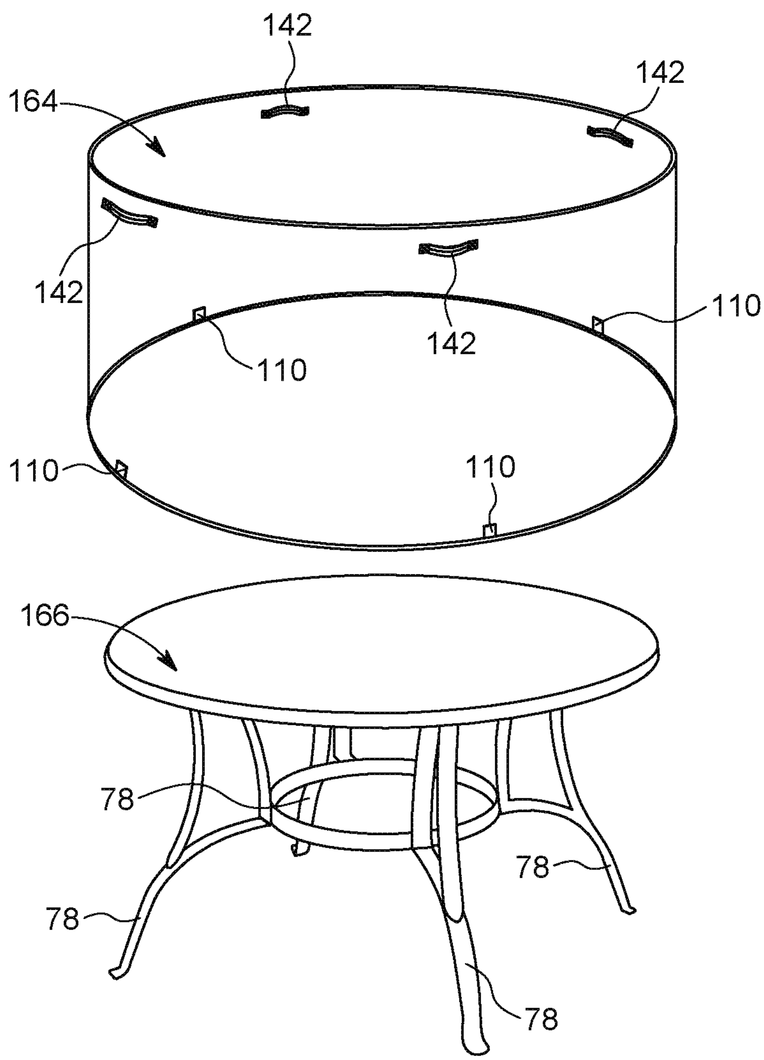
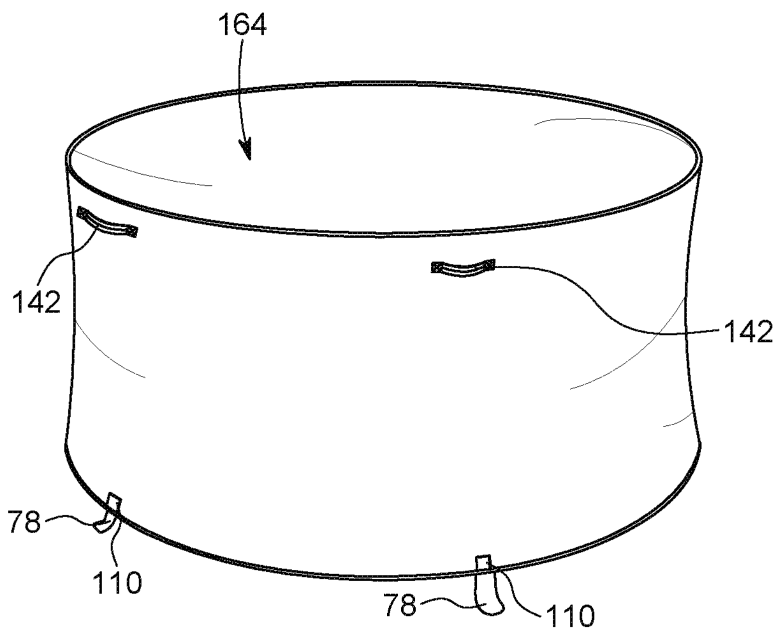



FIG. 15

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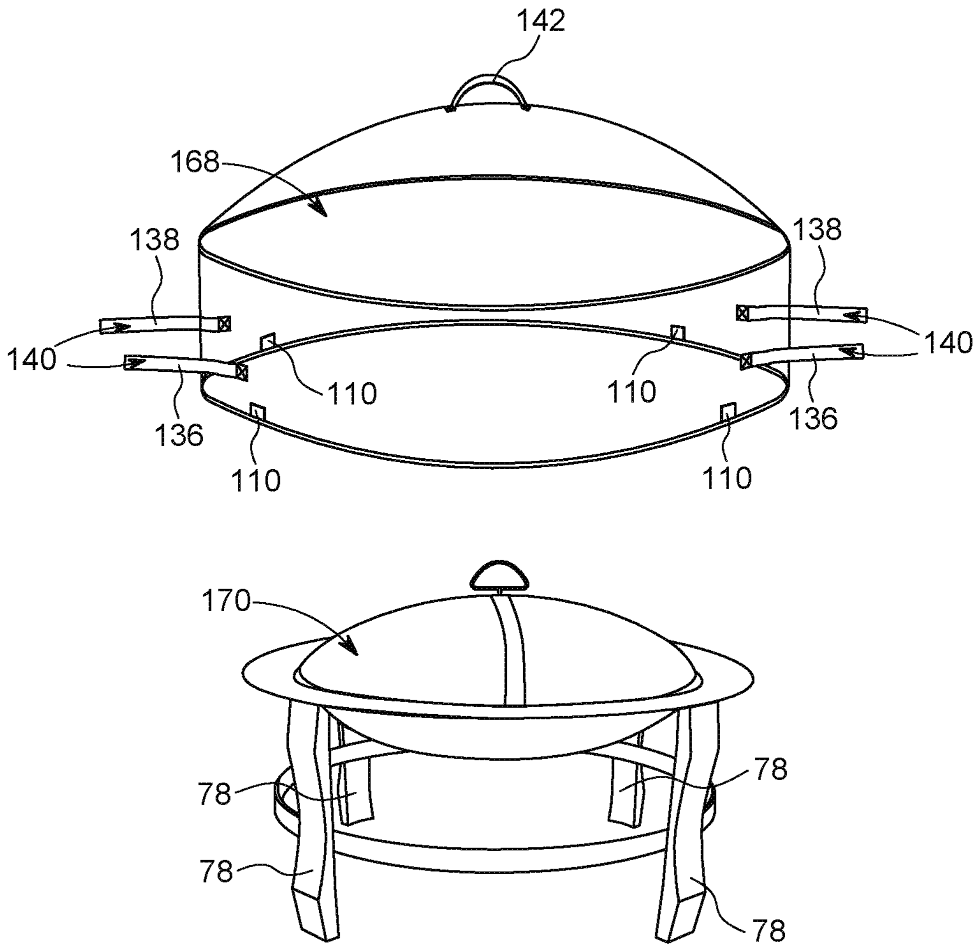


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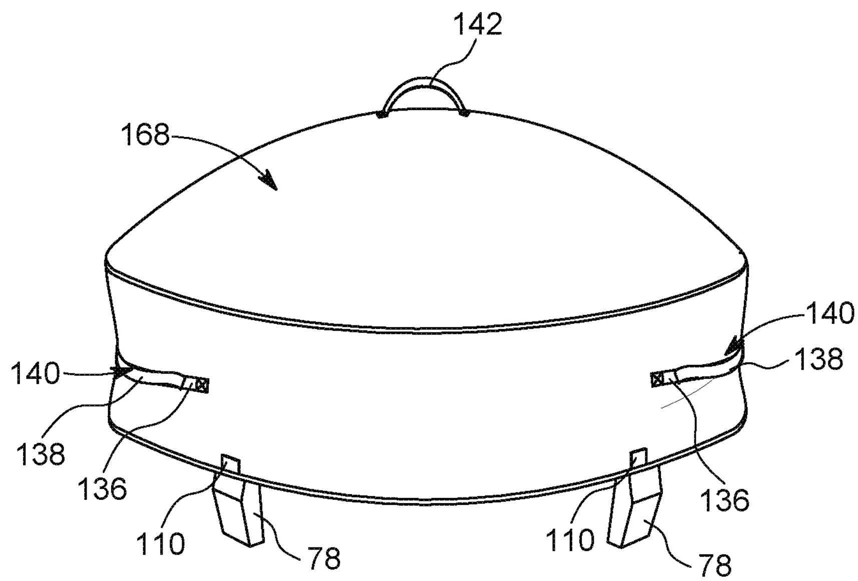



FIG. 18

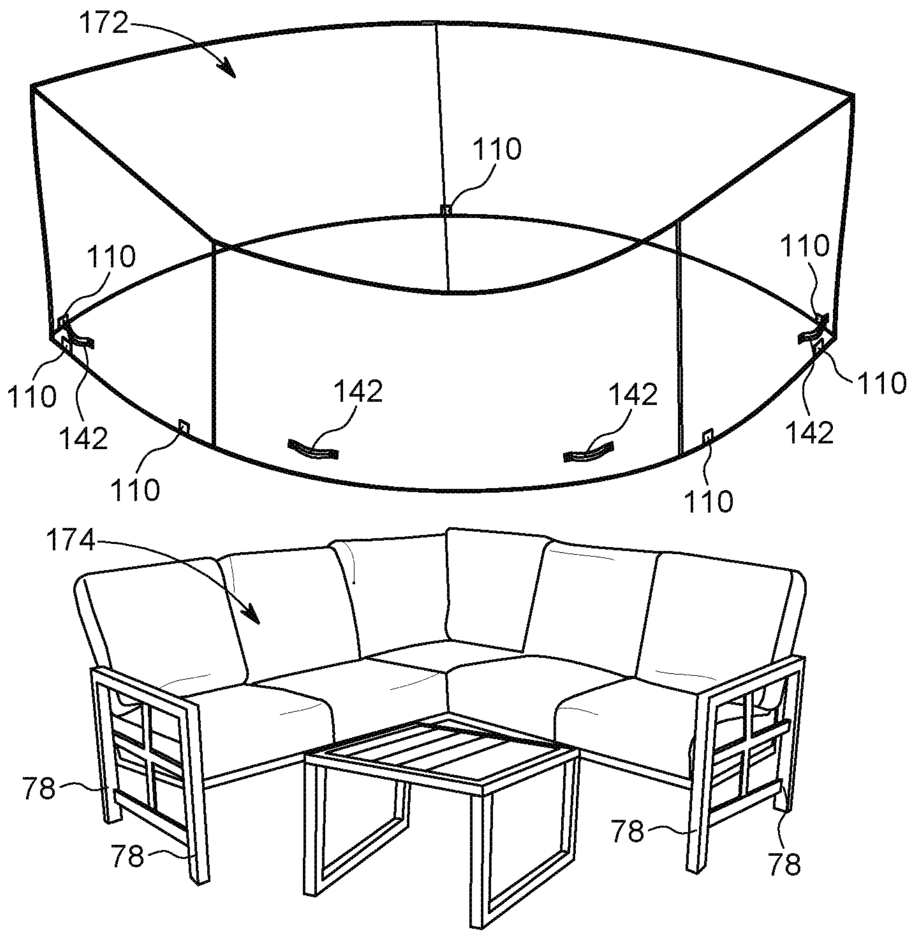



FIG. 19

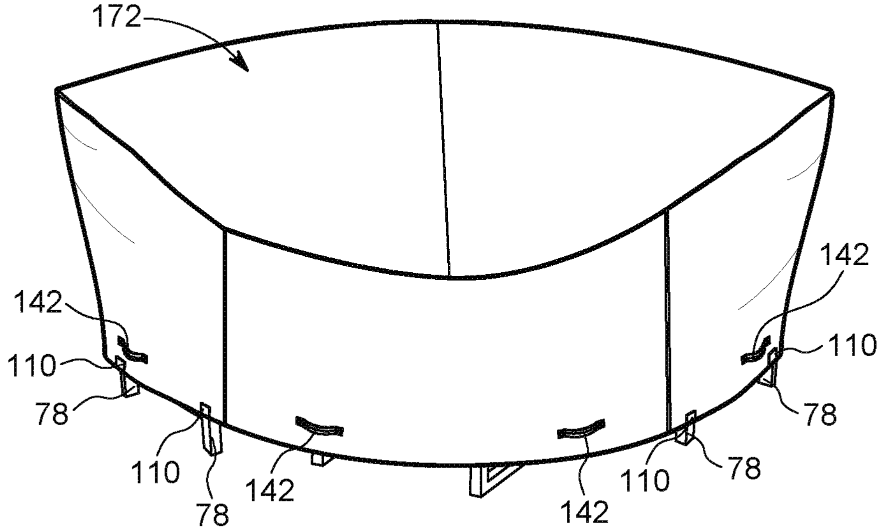



FIG. 20

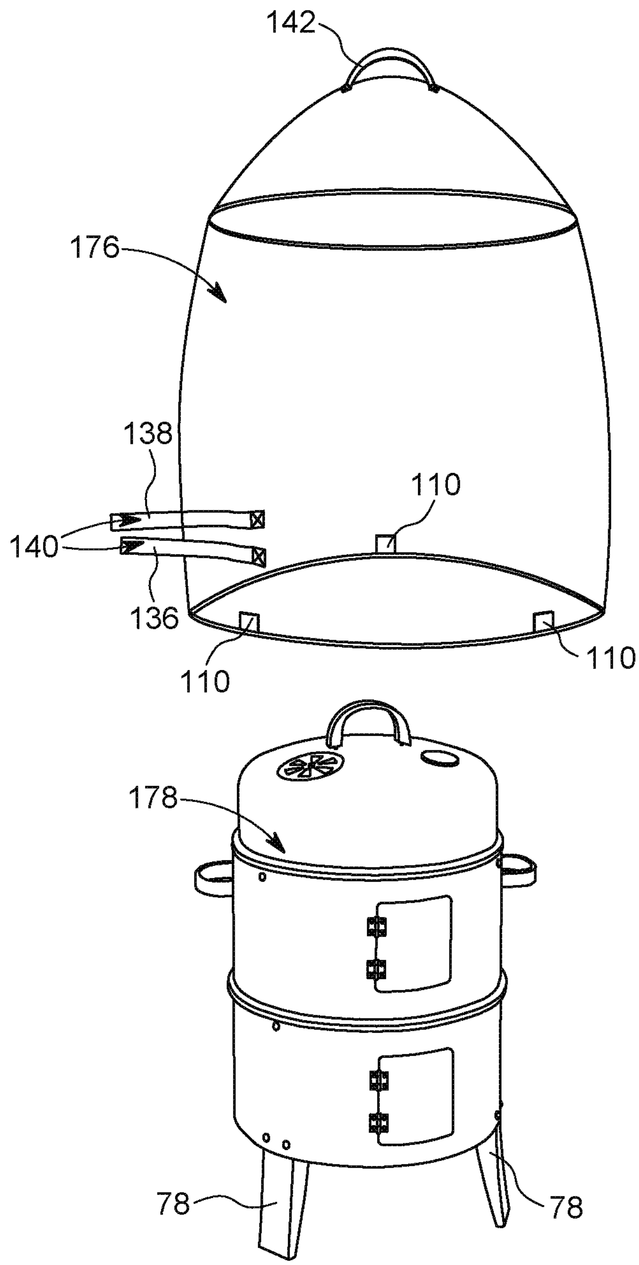



FIG. 21

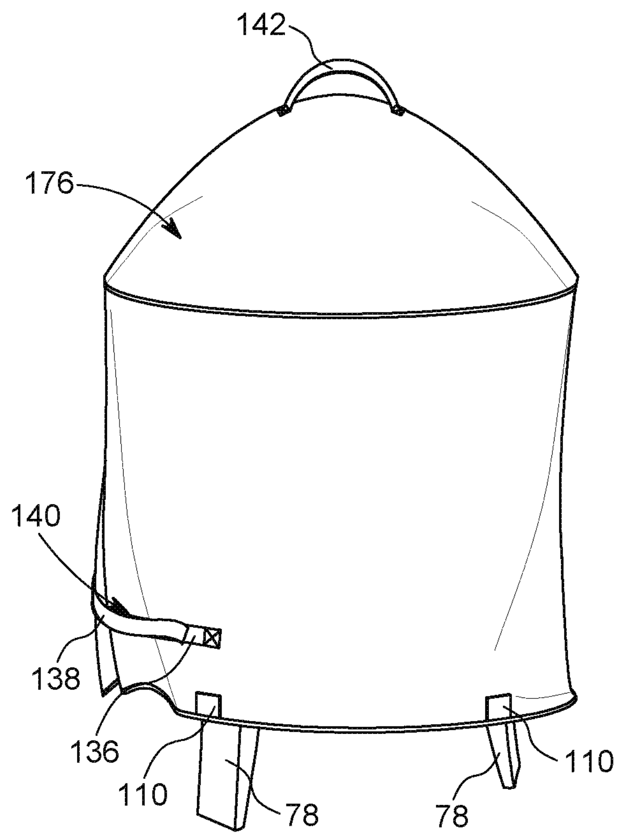



FIG. 22

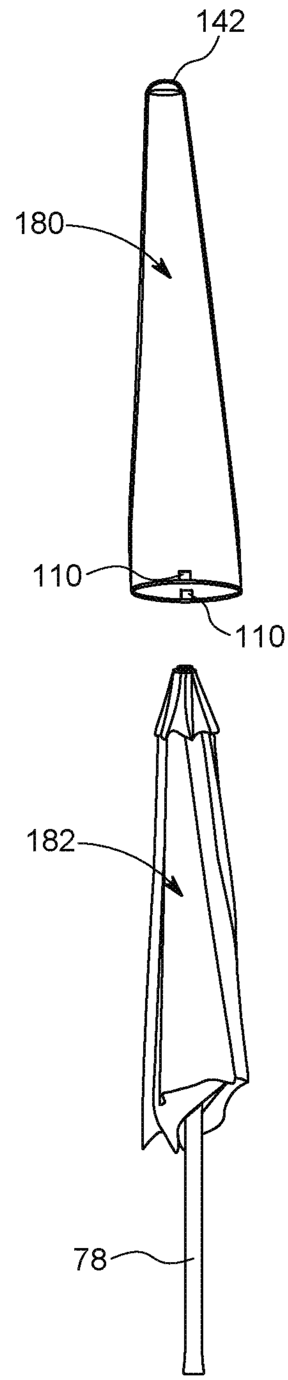



FIG. 23

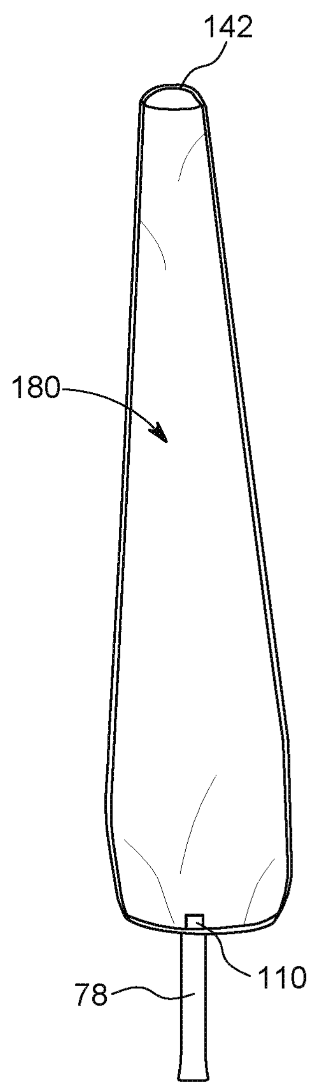
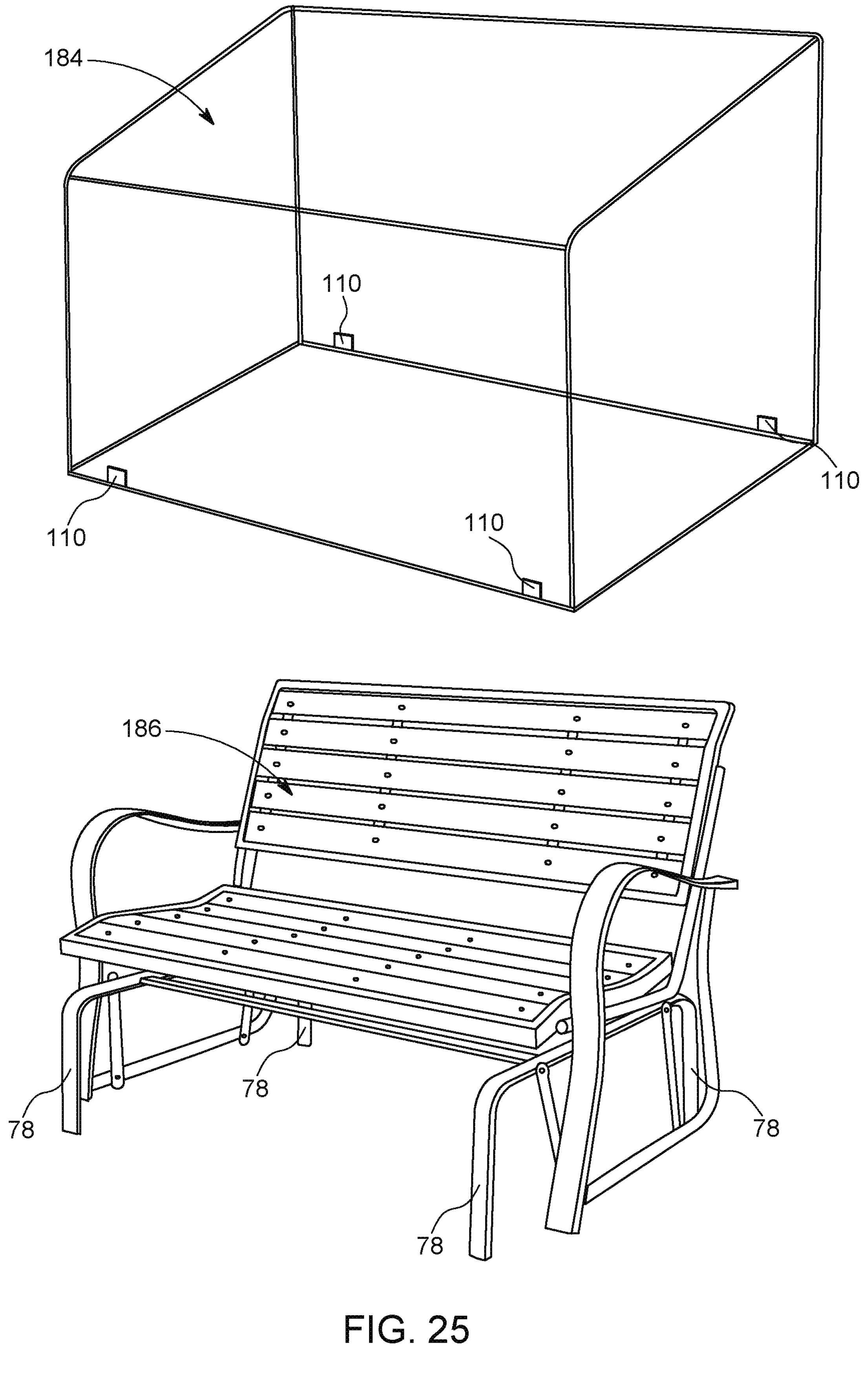



FIG. 24

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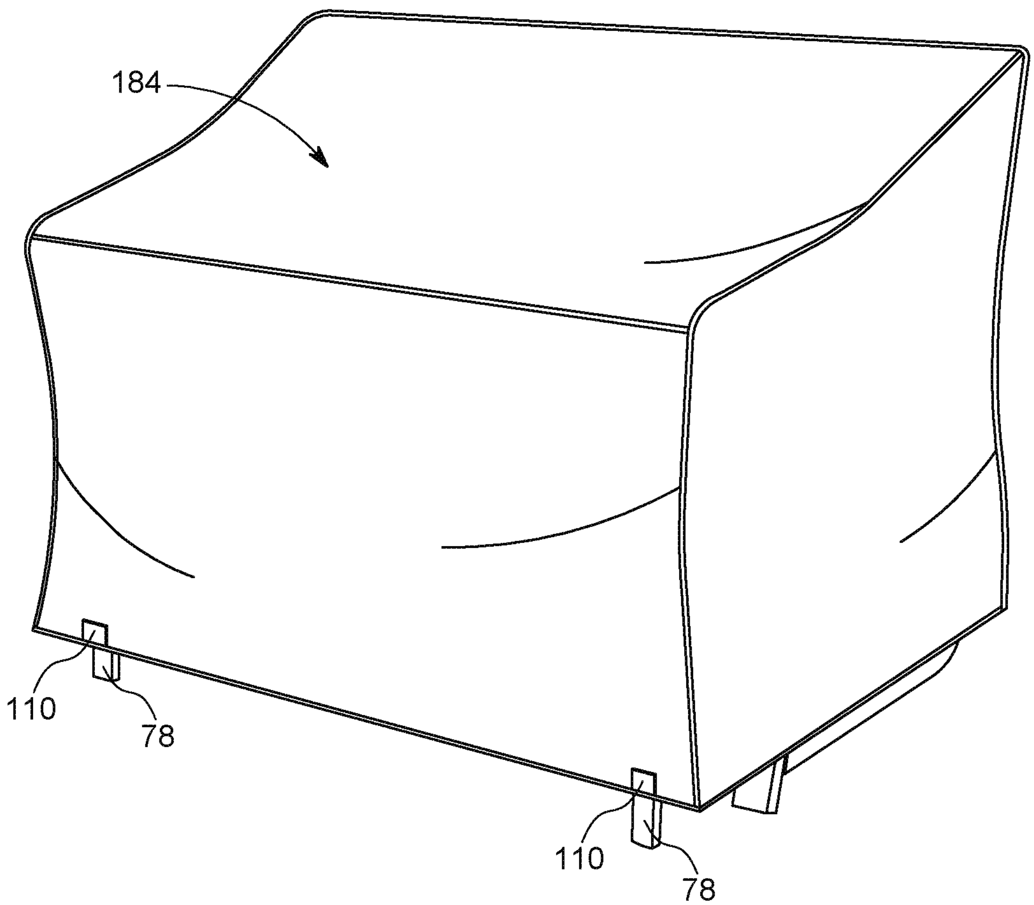


FIG. 26

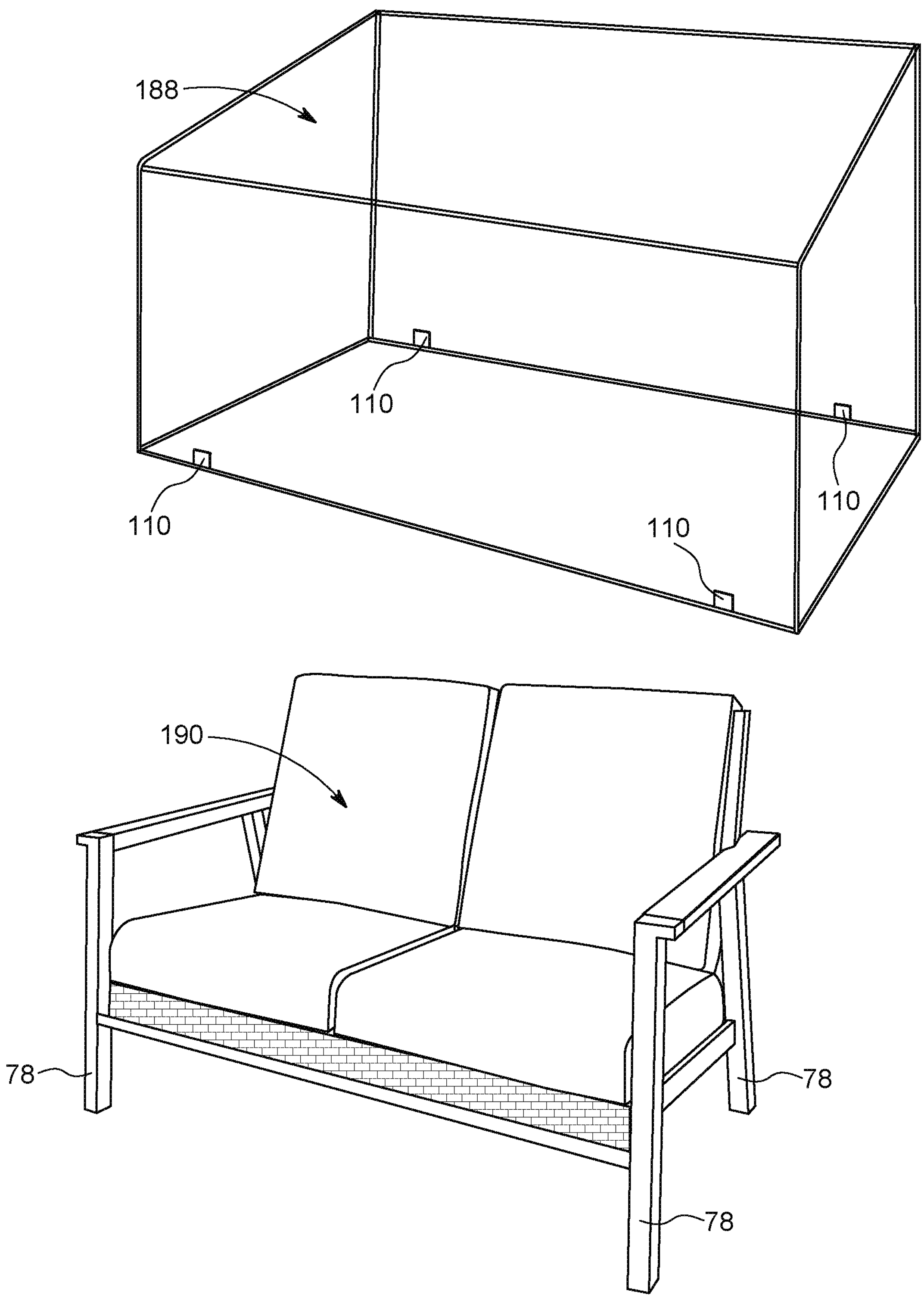


FIG. 27

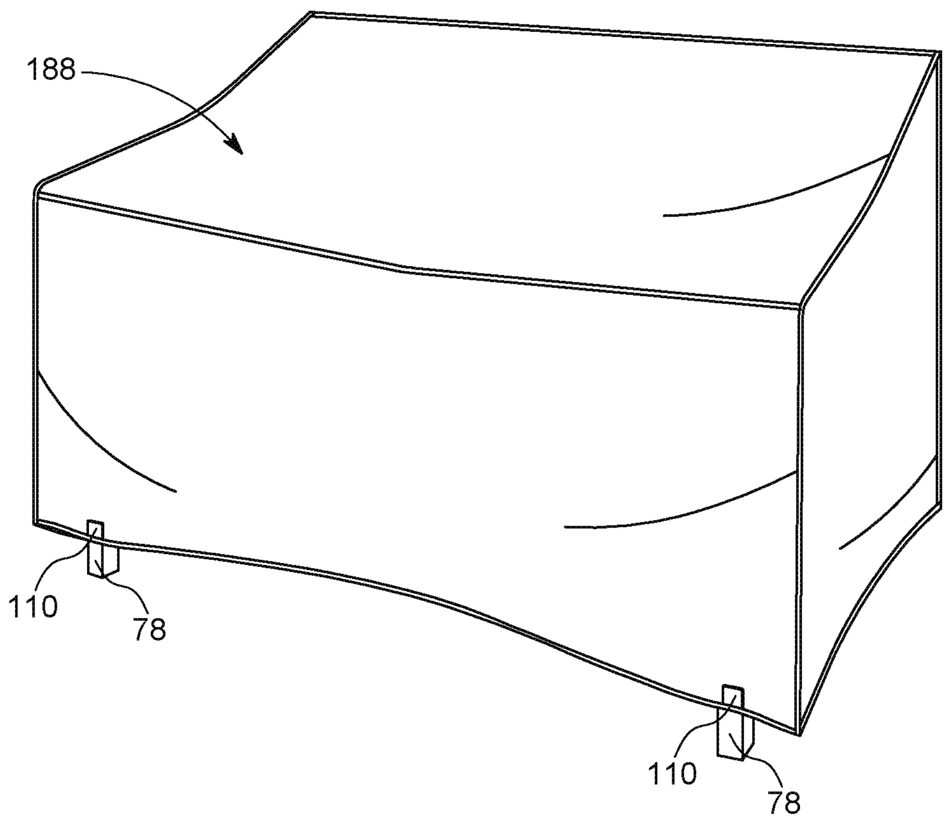


FIG. 28

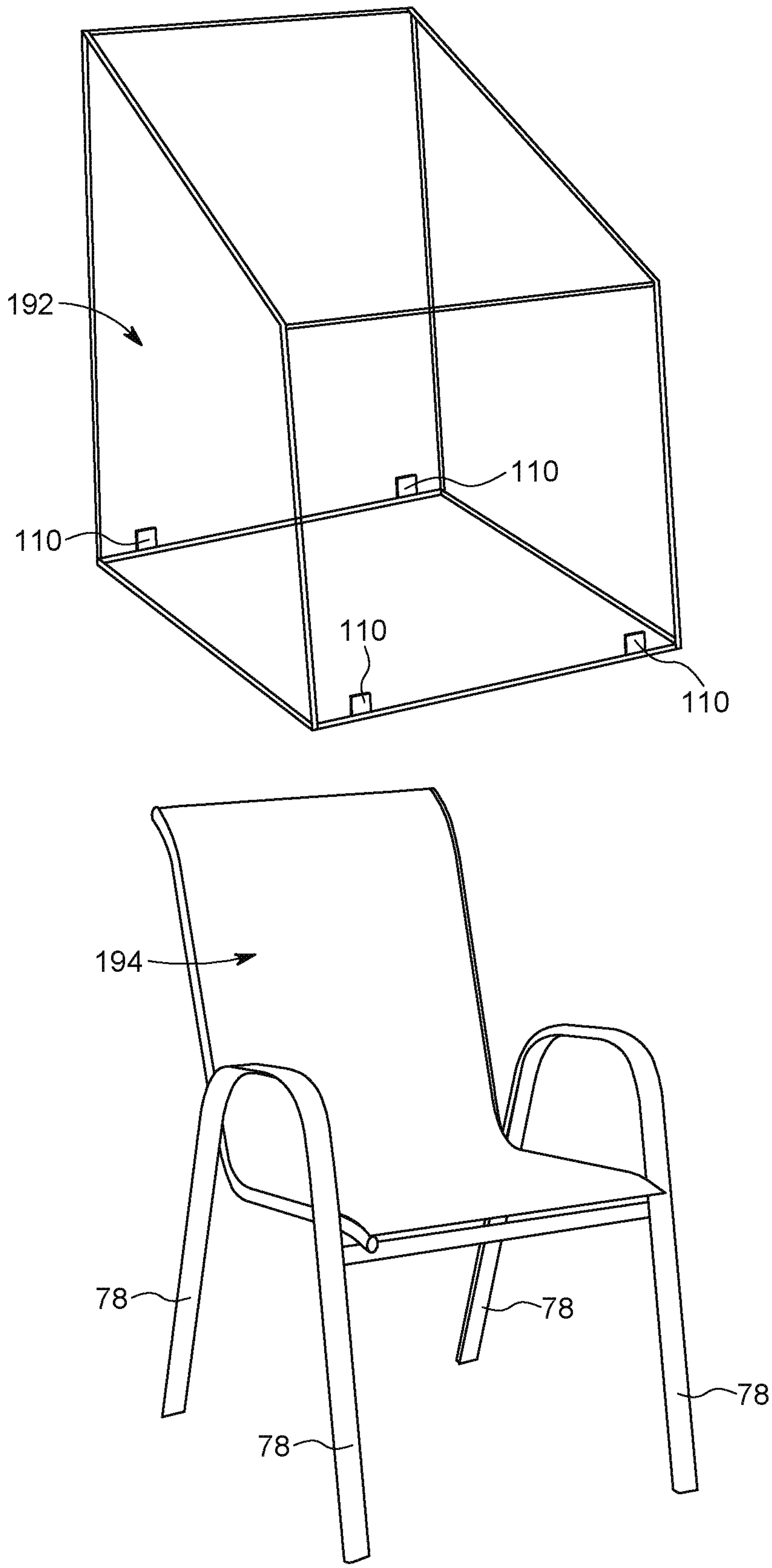


FIG. 29

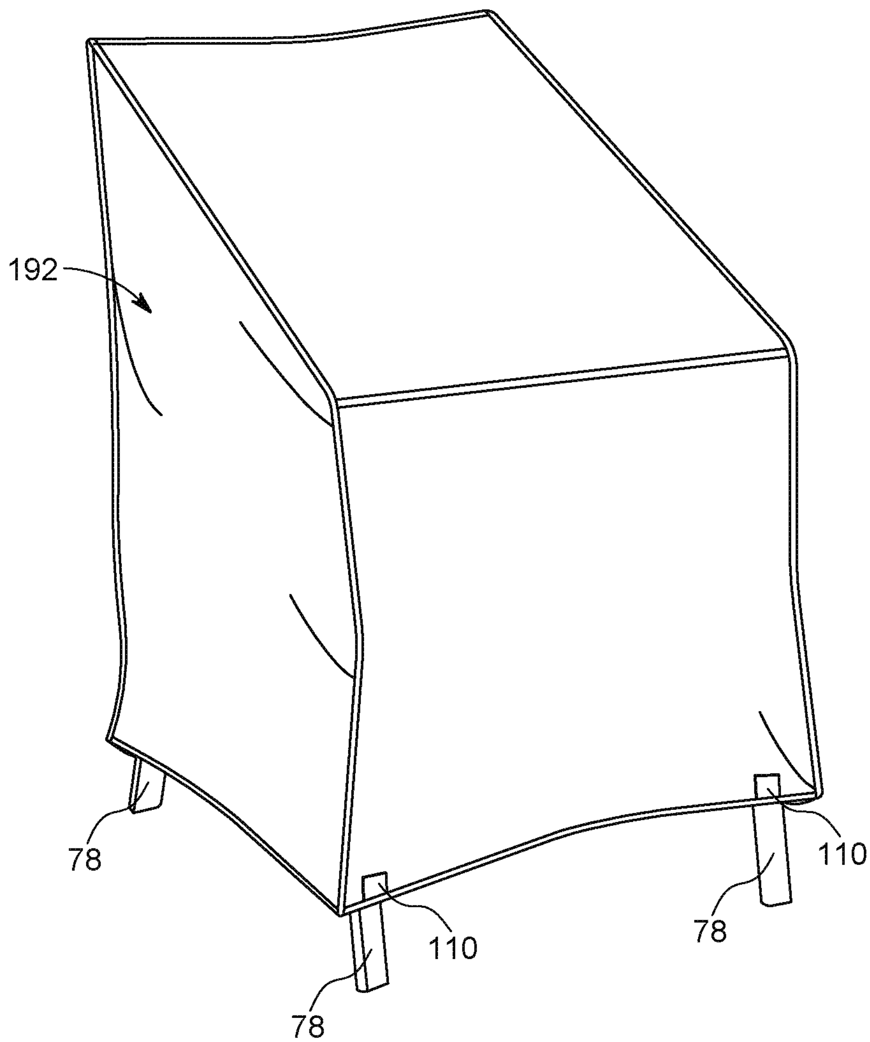


FIG. 30

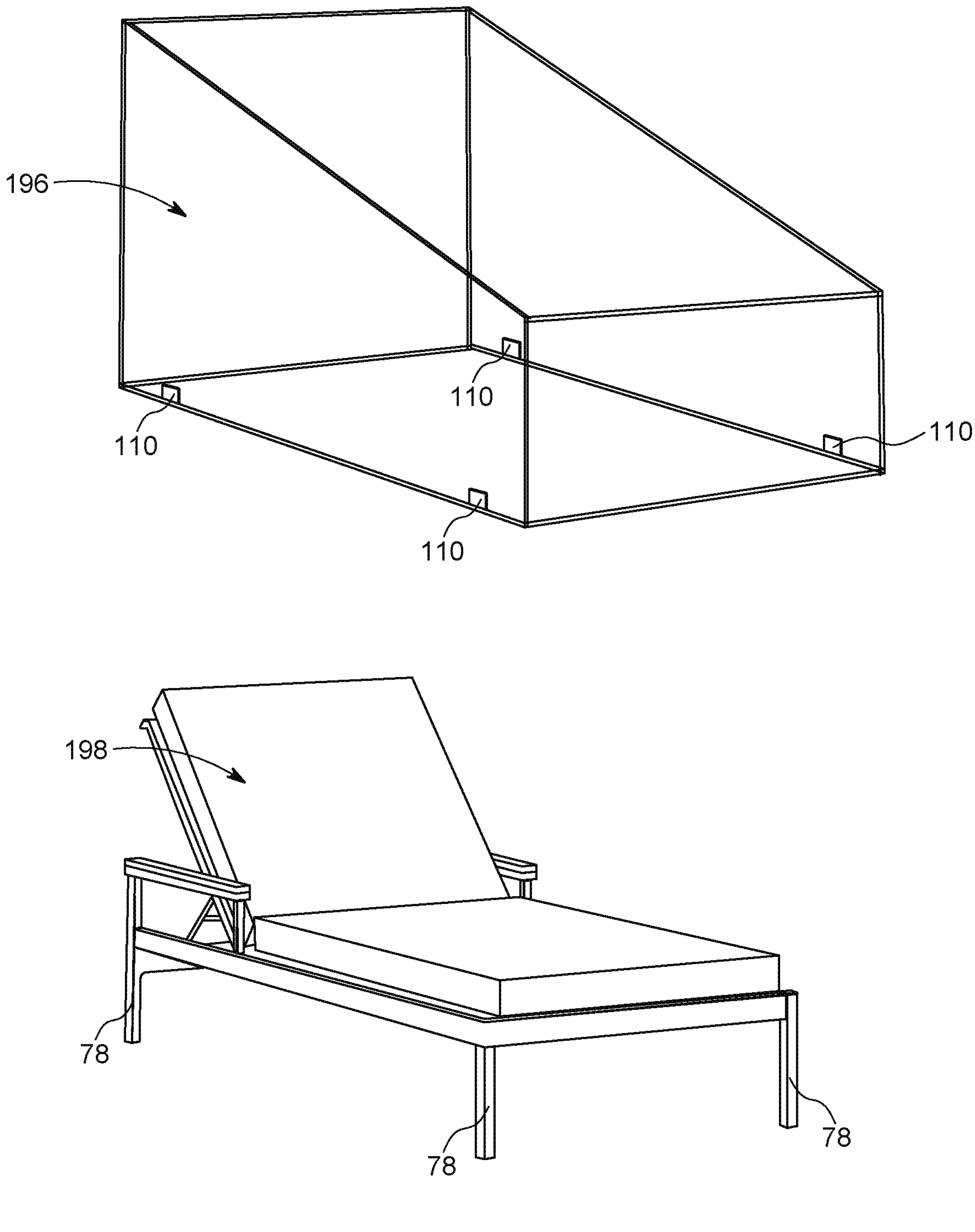


FIG. 31

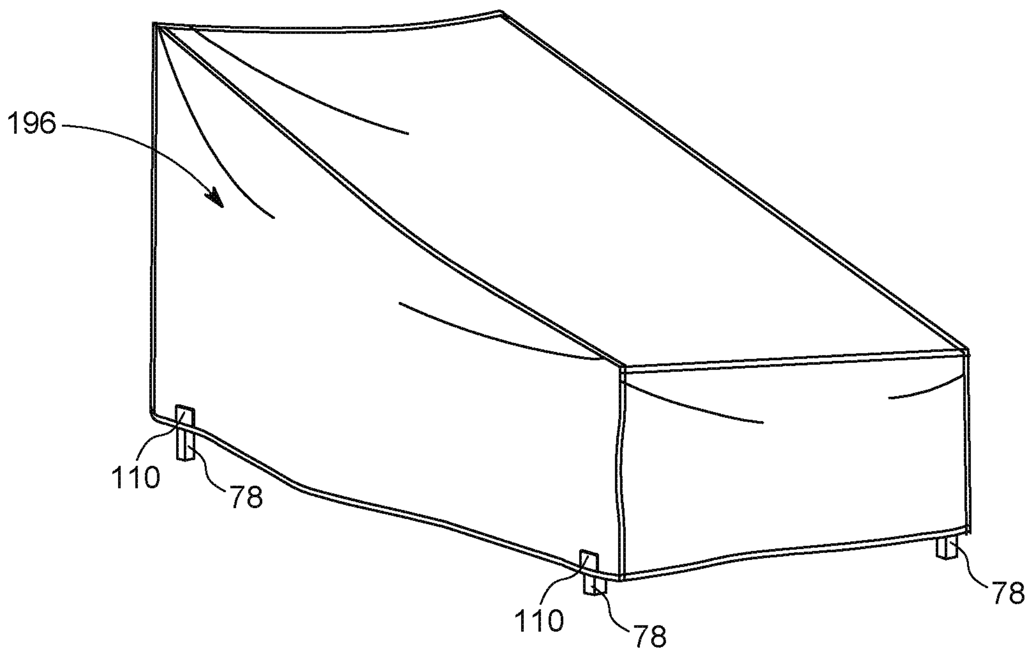


FIG. 32

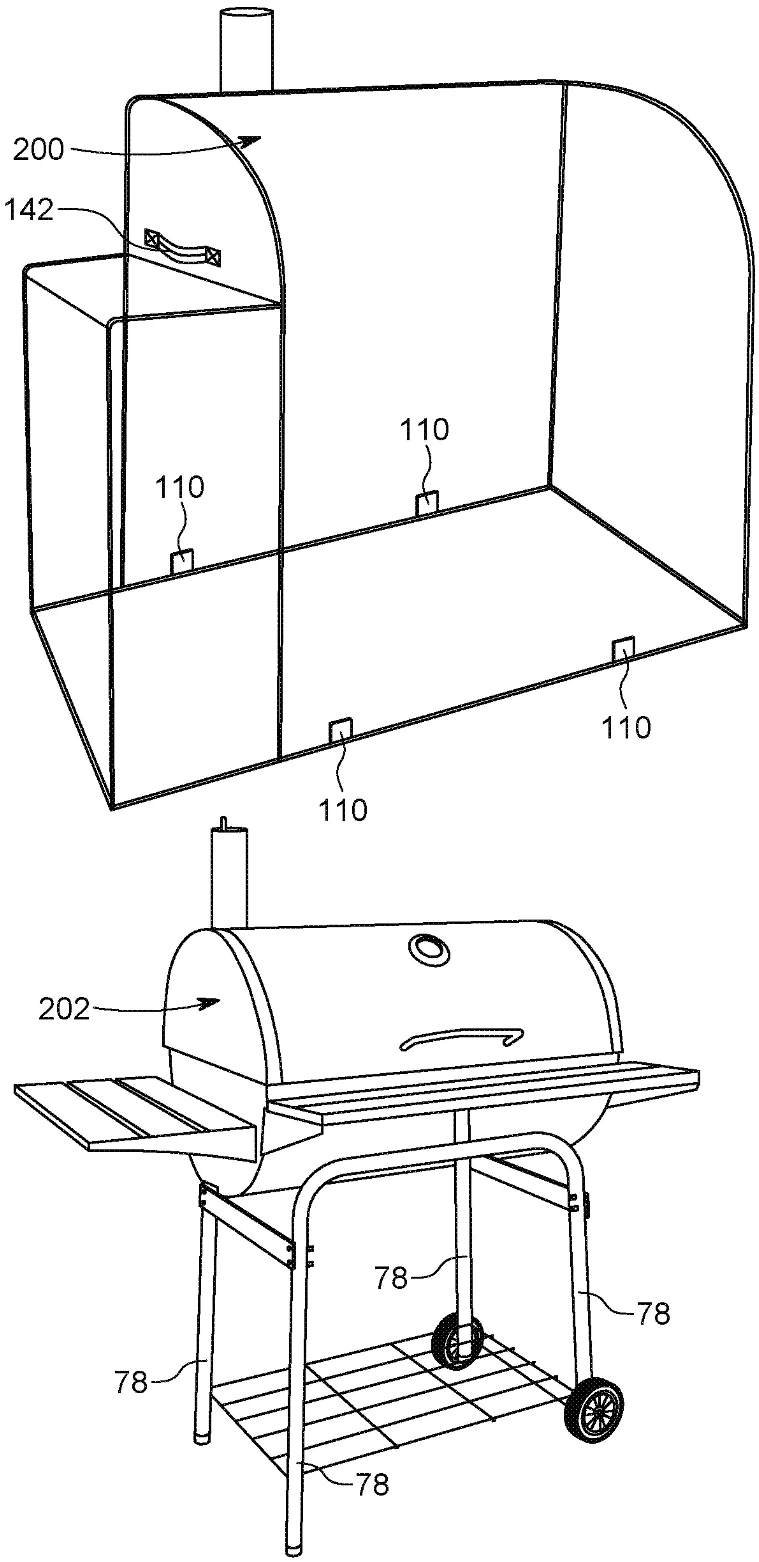


FIG. 33

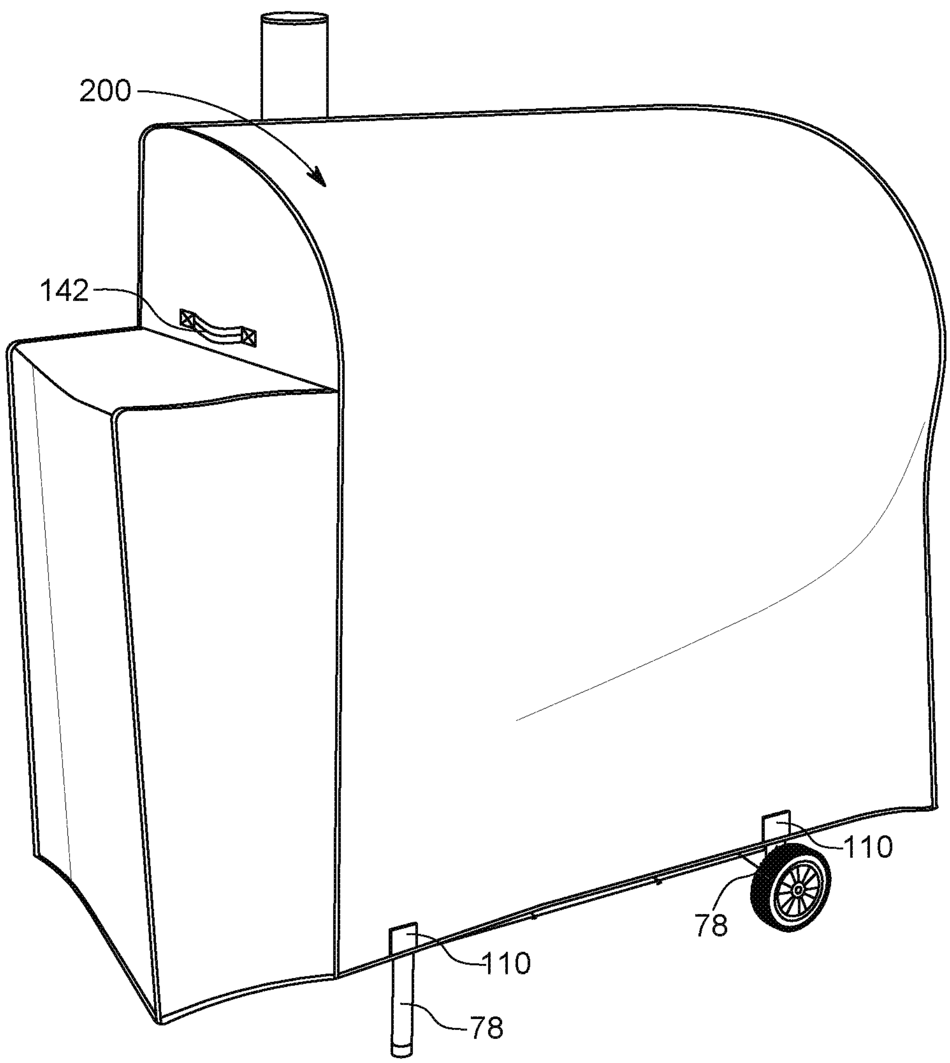


FIG. 34

# SELECTIVELY SECURABLE COVER

## CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS

This application is a Continuation-in-Part of and claims priority to U.S. patent application Ser. No. 18/172,004, filed Feb. 21, 2023 to Joshua Drew Walker, which is a Continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/881,075, filed May 22, 2020 to Joshua Drew Walker, now issued as U.S. Pat. No. 11,583,142, the entire disclosures of which are incorporated herein by reference.

## FIELD OF THE INVENTION

The present disclosure generally relates to outdoor equipment covers configured to be used with a variety of outdoor equipment.

## BACKGROUND

Outdoor equipment covers are utilized to provide protection for a grill or other outdoor equipment. Because the outdoor equipment typically spends most time out of doors, the outdoor equipment is exposed to weather and other environmental factors to which other indoor equipment is not exposed. The weather can include high winds, storms, and the like.

As such, it is common for outdoor equipment covers of the prior art to become dislodged and blow away. To counter this, some outdoor equipment covers of the prior art typically are fitted with various securing structures and/or are specifically fitted to a single model of the outdoor equipment. However, these securing structures require the user to emplace them correctly and securely every time. Further, the specifically fitted outdoor equipment covers tend to be expensive.

What is lacking in the prior art is an outdoor equipment cover that is a generic size and shape that is easy to emplace and secure. This background discussion is intended to provide information related to the present invention which is not necessarily prior art.

## BRIEF SUMMARY

Embodiments of the invention solve the above-mentioned problem (as well as other problems) by providing a selectively securable outdoor equipment cover that utilizes magnets to easily and quickly secure to outdoor equipment. The magnets are secured to a lower end of the outdoor equipment cover so as to automatically secure to a metallic component of the outdoor equipment when the outdoor equipment cover is emplaced over the outdoor equipment.

A first embodiment of the invention is broadly directed to an outdoor equipment cover configured to be utilized with outdoor equipment having a metallic component, the outdoor equipment cover comprising a cover body and a magnetic fastener. The cover body presents an outer edge disposed along a bottom side and a cover void therein configured to receive the outdoor equipment therein. The magnetic fastener is secured to the cover body. The magnetic fastener is configured to provide a magnetic force to keep the magnetic fastener selectively secured to the metallic component of the outdoor equipment so as to keep the cover body in place around the outdoor equipment therein.

A second embodiment of the invention is broadly directed to an outdoor equipment cover configured to be utilized with outdoor equipment having a metallic component, the outdoor equipment cover comprising a cover body, a magnetic fastener, and a secondary fastener. The cover body presents an outer edge disposed along a bottom side and a cover void therein configured to receive the outdoor equipment therein. The magnetic fastener is secured to the cover body. The magnetic fastener is configured to provide a magnetic force to keep the magnetic fastener selectively secured to the metallic component of the outdoor equipment so as to keep the cover body in place around the outdoor equipment therein. The secondary fastener is also secured to the cover body. The secondary fastener is configured to reduce a cross-sectional area of the cover void so as to prevent the outdoor equipment cover from being removed from the outdoor equipment while the secondary fastener is emplaced.

A third embodiment of the invention is broadly directed to a method of manufacturing an outdoor equipment cover. The method comprises steps of acquiring a polyester fabric; coating the polyester fabric with a protective coating; cutting the polyester fabric to a pattern shape; sewing the polyester fabric to form a cover body; inserting a magnet into a pocket; sealing the magnetic component into the pocket; and securing the pocket to the cover body to form the outdoor equipment cover.

Additional embodiments of the invention may be directed to a combination outdoor equipment and outdoor equipment cover, wherein the outdoor equipment cover includes the discussed magnetic fastener. Still other embodiments of the invention may be directed to a magnetic fastener configured to be added to an existing outdoor equipment cover. Yet other embodiments of the invention may be directed to a method of emplacing and removing a outdoor equipment cover over a piece of outdoor equipment. Yet still other embodiments will be discussed herein.

Advantages of these and other embodiments will become more apparent to those skilled in the art from the following description of the exemplary embodiments which have been shown and described by way of illustration. As will be realized, the present embodiments described herein may be capable of other and different embodiments, and their details are capable of modification in various respects. Accordingly, the drawings and description are to be regarded as illustrative in, nature and not as restrictive.

## BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

The Figures described below depict various aspects of systems and methods disclosed therein. It should be understood that each Figure depicts an embodiment of a particular aspect of the disclosed systems and methods, and that each of the Figures is intended to accord with a possible embodiment thereof. Further, wherever possible, the following description refers to the reference numerals included in the following Figures, in which features depicted in multiple Figures are designated with consistent reference numerals. The present embodiments are not limited to the precise arrangements and instrumentalities shown in the Figures.

FIG. **1** is a perspective view of a grill cover depicted along with a grill over which the grill cover is configured to be emplaced.

FIG. **2** is a perspective view of the grill cover emplaced over the grill.

FIG. **3** is a sectional view showing a magnet of the cover.

FIG. **4** is a vertical cross-section view of the magnet of the cover secured to a piece of outdoor equipment.

FIG. **5** is a perspective view of a griddle cover depicted along with a griddle over which the griddle cover is configured to be emplaced.

FIG. **6** is a perspective view of the griddle cover emplaced over the griddle.

FIG. **7** is a perspective view of a kettle grill cover depicted along with a kettle grill over which the kettle grill cover is configured to be emplaced.

FIG. **8** is a perspective view of the kettle grill cover emplaced over the kettle grill.

FIG. **9** is a perspective view of a chair cover depicted along with a chair over which the chair cover is configured to be emplaced.

FIG. **10** is a perspective view of the chair cover emplaced over the chair.

FIG. **11** is a perspective view of a table cover depicted along with a table over which the table cover is configured to be emplaced.

FIG. **12** is a perspective view of the table cover emplaced over the table.

FIG. **13** is a perspective view of a smoker cover depicted along with a smoker over which the smoker cover is configured to be emplaced.

FIG. **14** is a perspective view of the smoker cover emplaced over the smoker.

FIG. **15** is a perspective view of a round table cover depicted along with a round table over which the round table cover is configured to be emplaced.

FIG. **16** is a perspective view of the round table cover emplaced over the round table.

FIG. **17** is a perspective view of a fire pit cover depicted along with a fire pit over which the fire pit cover is configured to be emplaced.

FIG. **18** is a perspective view of the fire pit cover emplaced over the fire pit.

FIG. **19** is a perspective view of a sectional cover depicted along with a sectional over which the sectional cover is configured to be emplaced.

FIG. **20** is a perspective view of the sectional cover emplaced over the sectional.

FIG. **21** is a perspective view of a smoker grill cover depicted along with a smoker grill over which the smoker grill cover is configured to be emplaced.

FIG. **22** is a perspective view of the smoker grill cover emplaced over the smoker grill.

FIG. **23** is a perspective view of an umbrella cover depicted along with an umbrella over which the umbrella cover is configured to be emplaced.

FIG. **24** is a perspective view of the umbrella cover emplaced over the umbrella.

FIG. **25** is a perspective view of a bench glider cover depicted along with a bench glider over which the bench glider cover is configured to be emplaced.

FIG. **26** is a perspective view of the bench glider cover emplaced over the bench glider.

FIG. **27** is a perspective view of a bench cover depicted along with a bench over which the bench cover is configured to be emplaced.

FIG. **28** is a perspective view of the bench cover emplaced over the bench.

FIG. **29** is a perspective view of a chair cover depicted along with a chair over which the chair cover is configured to be emplaced.

FIG. **30** is a perspective view of the chair cover emplaced over the chair.

FIG. **31** is a perspective view of a chaise lounge cover depicted along with a chaise lounge over which the chaise lounge cover is configured to be emplaced.

FIG. **32** is a perspective view of the chaise lounge cover emplaced over the chaise lounge.

FIG. **33** is a perspective view of a barrel grill cover depicted along with a barrel grill over which the barrel grill cover is configured to be emplaced.

FIG. **34** is a perspective view of the barrel grill cover emplaced over the barrel grill.

The Figures depict exemplary embodiments for purposes of illustration only. One skilled in the art will readily recognize from the following discussion that alternative embodiments of the systems and methods illustrated herein may be employed without departing from the principles of the invention described herein. While the drawings do not necessarily provide exact dimensions or tolerances for the illustrated components or structures, the drawings, not including any purely schematic drawings, are to scale with respect to the relationships between the components of the structures illustrated therein.

## DETAILED DESCRIPTION

The present invention is susceptible of embodiment in many different forms. While the drawings illustrate, and the specification describes, certain preferred embodiments of the invention, it is to be understood that such disclosure is by way of example only. There is no intent to limit the principles of the present invention to the particular disclosed embodiments. For instance, the drawing figures do not limit the present invention to the specific embodiments disclosed and described herein. Furthermore, directional references (for example, top, bottom, up, and down) are used herein solely for the sake of convenience and should be understood only in relation to each other. For instance, a component might in practice be oriented such that faces referred to as "top" and "bottom" are sideways, angled or inverted relative to the chosen frame of reference. Use of directional terms such as "upper," "lower,", "top", "bottom", "above," "below", "front", "forward", "left" or "right", and etc. are intended merely for orientation, to describe the positions and/or orientations of various components relative to one another, and are not intended to impose limitations on any position and/or orientation of any embodiment of the invention relative to any reference point external to the reference.

### Exemplary Environment

Embodiments of the invention are directed to an outdoor equipment cover. As discussed above, outdoor equipment covers are utilized to provide protection for outdoor equipment. Because the outdoor equipment typically spends most time out of doors, the outdoor equipment is exposed to weather and other environmental factors to which other indoor equipment is not exposed. Examples of this weather can include high winds and rains. Rain and other precipitation can damage the outdoor equipment over time. The high winds can typically dislodge the outdoor equipment cover that is otherwise protecting the outdoor equipment, thus exposing the outdoor equipment to water damage (and often blowing the outdoor equipment cover away from the immediate area. As used herein, outdoor equipment may include, but is not limited to, grills, griddles, smokers, fire pits, fountains, chairs, chaise lounges, benches, gliders, couches, loveseats, tables, cabinets, other furniture, umbrellas, and other suitable outdoor equipment and objects.

Turning to FIG. **1**, an exemplary grill **12** is shown in relation to a grill cover **10**. Before discussing the grill cover

10 in detail, the grill 12 will be briefly described so as to orient the reader to an exemplary environment in which various embodiments of the invention may be utilized. It should be appreciated that the grill 12 discussed herein is only exemplary and that other embodiments of the invention may be configured to be utilized in combination with other grills, outdoor cooking devices, or other devices.

The exemplary grill 12 is a standard grill that may be utilized outside of a home or at some other outdoor location. The grill 12 generally comprises a grill body 14 and a lid 16. The grill 12 may further include one or more lateral protrusions 18. The grill 12 is oriented substantially vertically, such that a standing person can utilize the grill 12.

The grill body 14 includes a cooking segment 20 and a cabinet segment 22. The cooking segment 20 presents a front panel 24 and one or more side panels 26. The cooking segment 20 may also present a back panel (not illustrated). The front panel 24, the back panel, and the side panels 26 surround the heat source and the grill grates. The front panel 24, the back panel, and the side panels 26 provide thermal insulation so as to retain the heat within the cooking segment 20.

In some embodiments, the cabinet segment 22 includes a front panel 28 (which may be unitary with the front panel 24 of the cooking segment 20 or distinct therefrom), one or more side panels 30 (which may be unitary with the respective side panels 26 of the cooking segment 20 or distinct therefrom), a back panel (not illustrated), and a bottom panel 32. The front panel 28 of the cabinet segment 22 may have one or more doors 34 associated therewith. The door 34 may provide access to the interior components of the cabinet segment 22, such as a fuel tank and other cooking accessories. The cabinet segment 22 may also include one or more fuel ports 36 configured to interface with the fuel tank and the cooking element for the transfer of fuel.

The cabinet segment 22 may additionally or alternatively include braces 40 and posts 42. The braces 40 provide horizontal support and the posts 42 provide vertical support. The braces 40 and/or posts 42 may provide structural support so as to support the cooking segment 20 thereon. The braces 40 may include a front brace 44, a left brace 46, a rear brace 48, a right brace 50, and a cross brace 52. The posts 42 may include a front-left post 54, a front-right post 56, a rear-left post 58, and a rear-right post 60. The braces 40 and/or posts 42 may provide an intersection between the respective panels 28, 30, 32 of the cabinet segment 22. In other embodiments, not illustrated, the cabinet segment 22 may comprise at least one brace 40 and at least one post 42, without any panels.

The cooking segment 20 includes a heat source and grill grates (not illustrated). The heat source produces a flame or other heat which is transferred (typically through conduction) to the grill grates or other cooking surfaces. The cabinet segment 22 is configured to hold a fuel tank (such as a propane tank). Fuel from the fuel tank is burned by the heat source so as to produce the flame or other heat. The cabinet segment 22 may also include one or more legs 62 which may each have a wheel 64 or a foot (not illustrated). The wheel 64 may be a static wheel 66 or a caster wheel 68. Caster wheels 68 pivot about a vertical axis so as to allow for movement in multiple directions. Static wheels 66 rotate only about a horizontal axis so as to allow for movement only in a single direction.

The lid 16 is pivotably attached to the cooking segment 20 at a lid pivot 70. The lid 16 comprises a lid body 72 and a handle 74. The lid body 72 provides thermal insulation so as to retain heat within the cooking segment 20. The lid body 72 covers the cooking segment 20 when in a downward orientation and exposes the cooking segment 20 when in an upward orientation. Thus, the user may selectively cover the cooking segment 20 to retain heat during cooking and expose the cooking segment 20 to add, move, flip, or remove the food during the cooking process. The handle 74 is physically separated by the lid body 72, such as via one or more thermally insulating lid arms 76. The lid arms 76 prevent the handle 74 from becoming excessively heated during normal operation. The handle 74 is presented adjacent to the front panel 24 such that the user may grasp and lift the handle 74 so as to move the lid 16 to the upward orientation.

In embodiments of the invention, the grill cover 10 is configured to be utilized with a grill 12 having a metallic component 78, more specifically a ferromagnetic component. The grill cover 10 includes a magnet that is configured to selectively secure to the ferromagnetic component of the grill 12. In some embodiments, the ferromagnetic component is the front brace 44 and the rear brace 48. In some embodiments, the ferromagnetic component is the front-right post 56, the front-left post 54, the rear-right post 60, and the rear-left post 58. In some embodiments, the ferromagnetic component is the front brace 44. In some embodiments, the ferromagnetic component is the rear brace 48. In some embodiments, the ferromagnetic component is at least one door 34. In some embodiments, the ferromagnetic component is the back panel of the cabinet segment 22.

Embodiments of the invention may be directed to the covering of any of various types of grills. These include, but are not limited to, residential built-in grills, restaurant grills, commercial grills, food truck grills, competition grills, portable grills, and other grills. Embodiments of the invention may be directed to covering of any of various other types of outdoor cooking equipment. These include, but are not limited to, drum-style smokers, bullet-style smokers, vertical smokers, horizontal smokers, off-set smokers, cabinet-style smokers, egg-style smokers, outdoor pizza ovens, or other types of devices. Embodiments of the invention may be directed to covering other types of outdoor equipment. These include, but are not limited to, tools, structures, outdoor furniture, fire pits, space heaters, and the like. It should be appreciated that the above discussed devices and uses are only exemplary.

## Exemplary Grill Cover

The grill cover 10 is configured to be disposed over the grill 12 described above. The grill cover 10 is configured to be selectively secured to the grill 12, as discussed below. The grill cover 10 provides a protective barrier between the grill 12 and the exterior environment, which is typically an outdoor environment.

In embodiments, the grill cover 10 broadly comprises a cover body 80, a primary fastener 82, and a secondary fastener 84. The primary fastener 82 attaches to the grill 12 automatically so as to at least temporarily hold the grill cover 10 in place over the grill 12. The secondary fastener 84 is secured subsequently to provide additional securement of the grill cover 10 to the grill 12.

The cover body 80 of embodiments comprises an anterior panel 86, a posterior panel 88, and a traversing panel 90. The anterior panel 86 is configured to be aligned with the front panel 24 of the grill 12. The posterior panel 88 is spaced apart from the anterior panel 86 via the traversing panel 90. The traversing panel 90 keeps a spacing between the anterior panel 86 and the posterior panel 88. The grill 12 fits within the spacing, such that the grill cover 10 substantially surrounds the grill 12.

The anterior panel **86** and posterior panel **88** of embodiments each present a shape generally complementary to a shape presented by the grill **12**. In some embodiments, the anterior panel **86** and the posterior panel **88** each present a beveled rectangular shape, in which the top two corners of the rectangle are beveled, as best shown in FIG. **1**. This shape may additionally or alternatively be described as a hexagon having two right angles on a lower side. In other embodiments, the anterior panel **86** and the posterior panel **88** may each present another shape configured to be utilized in conjunction with a grill **12** of another shape.

It should be appreciated that in some embodiments, the grill cover **10** is substantially symmetrical about a vertical plane, such that the anterior sheet is similar to the posterior sheet. In these embodiments, the cover body **80** may be installed with either the anterior sheet or the posterior sheet aligned with the front panel **24** of the grill **12**.

The traversing panel **90** is disposed between the anterior sheet and the posterior sheet. In some embodiments, the traversing panel **90** comprises a set of sub-panels **92**. The sub-panels **92** may include a right sub-panel **94**, a top-right sub-panel **96**, a top sub-panel **98** (shown in FIG. **2**), a top-left sub-panel (not directly illustrated), and a left sub-panel **100** (shown in FIG. **1**). The sub-panels **92** may be unitary, such that the sub-panels **92** are defined by an angle at which the sub-panel is secured relative to the anterior panel **86** and/or the posterior panel **88**. The traversing panel **90** may be secured to the anterior panel **86** and/or the posterior panel **88** via stitching. Alternatively, the traversing panel **90** may be secured to the anterior panel **86** and/or the posterior panel **88** via a chemical adhesive. In still other embodiments, the traversing panel **90** may be monolithic with the anterior panel **86** and/or the posterior panel **88**.

The cover body **80** of embodiments presents an outer edge **102** disposed along a bottom side **104**. The outer edge **102** includes a lower side of the anterior panel **86**, two lower sides of the traversing panel **90**, and a lower side of the posterior panel **88**. As can be best seen in FIG. **1**, the outer edge **102** presents a generally rectangular shape about a horizontal cross-section. The outer edge **102** is at least large enough to fit over the grill **12** (as shown in FIG. **1**) such that it may be reduced so as to stay in contact with the grill **12** (as shown in FIG. **2**).

The outer edge **102** may include a facing **106**, as best illustrated in FIG. **4**. The facing **106** is a distinct fabric segment that is disposed over the outer edge **102** of the cover body **80**. The facing **106** is sewn over the outer edge **102** to protect the outer edge **102** from raveling. In some embodiments, the facing **106** is a continuous fabric segment. In other embodiments, the facing **106** is distinct for each of the panels **86**, **88**, **90** of the cover body **80**. In other embodiments of the invention, not illustrated, the outer edge **102** of the cover body **80** is hemmed or otherwise terminated. In still other embodiments, also not illustrated, the outer edge **102** is hemmed in addition to the facing **106** disposed thereon,

The cover body **80** presents a cover void **108** therein configured to receive the grill **12** therein. The cover void **108** is defined by the outer edge **102** and the interior of the cover body **80**. The void is reduced once the grill cover **10** is disposed over the grill **12**, as shown in FIG. **2**. The void is reduced through the primary fastener **82** and/or secondary fastener **84** constricting the outer edge **102**, so as to prevent the outer edge **102** from being removed up and over the grill **12**, as discussed below.

In embodiments of the invention, the grill cover **10** includes a magnetic fastener **110** secured to the cover body **80** so as to act as a primary fastener **82** of the cover body **80** to the grill **12**. The magnetic fastener **110** may be disposed along the outer edge **102** of the cover body **80** (as shown in FIGS. **1** and **3**), such that the magnetic fastener **110** will be disposed near the bottom side **104** when the grill cover **10** is emplaced over the grill **12** (as shown in FIG. **2**).



The magnetic fastener **110** is configured to provide a magnetic force to keep the magnetic fastener **110** selectively secured to the metallic component **78** of the grill **12** so as to keep the cover body **80** in place around the grill **12** therein. The magnetic fastener **110** being secured to the grill **12** is best shown in FIG. **4**. It should be appreciated that the magnetic fastener **110** will adhere to the grill **12** without being directly applied in many instances. As the grill cover **10** is place over the grill **12**, as discussed below, the magnetic fastener **110** will automatically adhere to the metallic component **78** of the grill **12**, without being directly adhered by the user.

In embodiments of the invention, the magnetic fastener **110** comprises a magnet **112** and a pocket **114**. The pocket **114** is secured to the cover body **80**, and the magnet **112** is disposed within the pocket **114**. The pocket **114** and the magnet **112** are best illustrated in FIGS. **3** and **4**. As can be seen, the pocket **114** is disposed along the outer edge **102**. As best shown in FIG. **1**, the pocket **114** is disposed at least partially within the cover void **108**. Disposing the pocket **114** within the cover void **108**, as opposed to external to the cover body **80**, increases the magnetic force applied by the magnet **112** on the metallic component **78** of the grill **12**.

The pocket **114** is best shown in FIGS. **3** and **4**. The pocket **114** of embodiments presents a generally rectangular shape. The pocket **114** comprises a pocket sheet **116** that is folded so as to present a pocket void **118**. The pocket sheet **116** may be folded (as shown in FIG. **4**) or otherwise secured so as to form a cover-side sheet and a grill-side sheet. The pocket void **118** is disposed between the cover-side sheet and the grill-side sheet. The pocket void **118** has the magnet **112** permanently disposed therein. In some embodiments, the pocket sheet **116** is distinct from the respective panel **86**, **88**, **90** of the cover body **80**. In other embodiments, the pocket **114** is formed of a sheet that is unitary with at least a portion of the cover body **80**. In these embodiments, the pocket **114** is formed by folding a protrusion of the cover body **80**.

In embodiments of the invention, best shown in FIG. **4**, the pocket **114** is secured via the facing **106**. The facing **106** surrounds the respective panel **86**, **88**, **90**, the cover-side sheet, and the grill-side sheet. A seam **120** is disposed through an exterior side of the facing **106**, the respective panel **86**, **88**, **90**, the cover-side sheet, the grill-side sheet, and an interior side of the facing **106**. Thus, the pocket **114** is secured to the cover body **80** by a seam **120** along the outer edge **102** of the cover body **80**.

In some embodiments, the pocket **114** is movable independent of the cover body **80**. This independent movability allows the pocket **114** to fall inward (e.g., toward the grill **12**). Falling inward places the magnet **112** disposed within the pocket **114** nearer to the grill **12**. This allows an increased likelihood that the magnet **112** will automatically secure to the metallic component **78** of the grill **12**.

The magnet **112** is permanently disposed within the pocket **114**. The pocket **114** may thus include side seams **122** to secure the cover-side sheet to the grill-side sheet. The side seams **122** are best shown in FIG. **3**. The magnet **112** may thus be inserted into the pocket **114** before the side seam **122** and/or the bottom seam is secured. This permanently secures the magnet **112** within the pocket **114**, such that the magnet **112** is not removable during normal operation of the grill cover **10**.

The magnet **112** is a material or object that produces a magnetic field. The magnetic field produces a force that pulls on other ferromagnetic material, such as the metallic component **78** of the grill **12** discussed above. In embodiments, the magnet **112** is a permanent magnet which creates its own persistent magnetic field. In embodiments, the magnet **112** presents a generally flat cylindrical shape, as shown in FIG. **3**. In other embodiments, the magnet **112** may present a rectangular shape, a square shape, an elliptical shape, or some other shape.

In embodiments of the invention, the grill cover **10** includes a set of magnetic fasteners **110**. The set of magnetic fasteners **110** are disposed on the cover body **80**. In these embodiments, the above-discussed magnetic fastener **110** is a first magnetic fastener **124** and the grill cover **10** further comprises a second magnetic fastener **126**, a third magnetic fastener **128**, and a fourth magnetic fastener **130**. An example of this embodiment is best shown in FIG. **1**.

In some of these embodiments, as shown in FIG. **1**, the first magnetic fastener **124** and the second magnetic fastener **126** are disposed on the anterior panel **86** of the cover body **80**, and the third magnetic fastener **128** and the fourth magnetic fastener **130** are disposed on the posterior panel **88** of the cover body **80**. The first magnetic fastener **124** is laterally spaced from the second magnetic fastener **126** so as to interface with the metallic component **78** of the grill **12** along a left side **132** and a right side **134**. The third magnetic fastener **128** is laterally spaced from the fourth magnetic fastener **130** so as to interface with the metallic component **78** of the grill **12** along the left side **132** and the right side **134**.

It should be appreciated that the metallic component **78** of the grill **12** interfaced by the respective magnetic fasteners **110** may be distinct, depending upon the construction of the grill **12** over which the grill cover **10** is emplaced. Thus, the grill **12** may include a first metallic component **78**, a second metallic component **78**, a third metallic component **78**, and/or a fourth metallic component **78**. The metallic component **78** may be any of the above-discussed braces **40**, posts **42 42**, panels **28**, **30**, **32**, doors **34**, etc. Thus, in some instances, the first magnetic fastener **124** and the second magnetic fastener **126** are configured to secure to the first metallic component **78** of the grill **12**, and the third magnetic fastener **128** and the fourth magnetic fastener **130** are configured to secure to the second metallic component **78** of the grill **12**. As an example, the first metallic component **78** may be the front brace **44** of the cabinet segment **22** and the second metallic component **78** may be the rear brace **48** of the cabinet segment **22**. As another example, the first metallic component **78** may be the front-left post **54** (as shown in FIG. **4**), the second metallic component **78** may be the front-right post **56**, the third metallic component **78** may be the rear-left post **58**, and the fourth metallic component **78** may be the rear-right post **60**. FIG. **4** shows the first metallic component **78** being the front-left post **54** being secured to the magnet **112** through the pocket **114**, which is secured to the front panel **24** of the cover body **80** via the facing **106**.

In other embodiments, the grill cover **10** includes the cover body **80**, a first magnetic fastener **124**, and a second magnetic fastener **126**, with both magnetic fasteners **110** disposed along the outer edge **102** of the cover body **80**. In still other embodiments, the grill cover **10** includes the cover body **80**, a first magnetic fastener **124**, and a second magnetic fastener **126**; with the first magnetic fastener **124** being disposed along the outer edge **102** and the second magnetic fastener **126** being disposed on the traversing panel **90** away from the outer edge **102**. In these embodiments, the second magnetic fastener **126** is configured to be secured to the lid **16** or other second metallic component **78** of the grill **12**.

In embodiments of the invention, the grill cover **10** includes at least one secondary fastener **84**. The secondary fastener **84** is configured to be secured and/or tightened by the user after the primary fastener **82** has been secured to the grill **12**. The primary fastener **82** and the second fastener thus work together to keep the grill cover **10** emplaced over the grill **12**. In embodiments, the secondary fastener **84** reduces the cross-sectional area of the void opening of the cover body **80**, as best seen by comparing FIG. **1** to FIG. **2**.

In some embodiments of the invention, the secondary fastener **84** includes an anterior strap **136** and a posterior strap **138**. The anterior strap **136** and the posterior strap **138** are each provided with a hook-and-loop fastener **140** (commonly referred to as VELCRO), such that the anterior strap **136** remains secured to the posterior strap **138** via the hook-and-loop fastener **140**. The user may thus emplace the grill cover **10** over the grill **12** such that the primary fasteners **82** engage one or more metallic components **78** of the grill **12**, and then the user may tighten or otherwise secure the secondary fastener **84** to provide additional securement of the grill cover **10** over the grill **12**, as is shown in FIG. **2**. In other embodiments of the invention, the secondary fastener **84** may include another fastening structure, such as a loop, a button, a clip, an eyelet, or the like.

Other Exemplary Covers

Each of the below exemplary covers are briefly discussed to show the scope of possible embodiments for the outdoor equipment cover. Each exemplary cover is shown with magnetic fasteners **110**, hook-and-loop fasteners **140**, and/or handles **142**. The hook-and-loop fasteners **140** shown consist of anterior strap **136** and posterior strap **138**. In other embodiments they can be any secondary fastener **84** structure including a loop, a button, a clip, an eyelet, or the like. Handles **142** can be located on a variety of locations and are meant to assist a user in emplacing and removing the exemplary cover. Each exemplary cover provides a protective barrier between the equipment and the exterior environment, which is typically an outdoor environment.

FIGS. **5** and **6** illustrate a griddle cover **144** configured to be disposed over, and selectively secured to, a griddle **146**. The griddle cover **144** may include magnetic fasteners **110** on a lower end to couple to magnetic components **78** of the griddle **146**. Hook-and-loop fasteners **140** can be located on a lower portion of the griddle cover **144** to provide additional securement of the griddle cover **144** to the griddle **146**. Handles **142** may be located on a top portion of the griddle cover **144**.

FIGS. **7** and **8** illustrate a kettle grill cover **148** configured to be disposed over, and selectively secured to, a kettle grill **150**. The kettle grill cover **148** may include magnetic fasteners **110** on a lower end to couple to magnetic components **78** of the kettle grill **150**. A hook-and-loop fastener **140** can be located on a bottom portion of the kettle grill cover **148** to provide additional securement of the kettle grill cover **148** to the kettle grill **150**. A handle **142** may be located on the top of the kettle grill cover **148**.

FIGS. **9** and **10** illustrate a chair cover **152** configured to be disposed over, and selectively secured to, a chair **154**. The chair cover **152** may include magnetic fasteners **110** on a lower end to couple to magnetic components **78** of the chair **154**.

FIGS. **11** and **12** illustrate a table cover **156** configured to be disposed over, and selectively secured to, a table **158**, such as a patio table or other suitable type of table. The table cover **156** may include magnetic fasteners **110** on a lower end to couple to magnetic components **78** of the table **158**. Handles **142** can be located near the top of the table cover **156**.

FIGS. **13** and **14** illustrate a smoker cover **160** configured to be disposed over, and selectively secured to, a smoker **162**, such as a pellet smoker or other suitable type of smoker. The smoker cover **160** includes magnetic fasteners **110** on a lower end to couple to magnetic components **78** of the smoker **162**. Hook-and-loop fasteners **140** can be located on a bottom portion of the smoker cover **160** to provide additional securement of the smoker cover **160** to the smoker **162**. Handles **142** are located near the top of the smoker cover **160**.

FIGS. **15** and **16** illustrate a round table cover **164** configured to be disposed over, and selectively secured to, a round table **166**, such as a round patio table or other suitable type of table. The round table cover **164** may include magnetic fasteners **110** on a lower end to couple to magnetic components **78** of the round table **166**. Handles **142** can be located on the top of the round table cover **164**.

FIGS. **17** and **18** illustrate a fire pit cover **168** configured to be disposed over, and selectively secured to, a fire pit **170**. The fire pit cover **168** may include magnetic fasteners **110** on a lower end to couple to magnetic components **78** of the fire pit **170**. Hook-and-loop fasteners **140** can be located on a bottom portion of the fire pit cover **168** to provide additional securement of the fire pit cover **168** to the fire pit **170**. A handle **142** may be located on a top portion of the fire pit cover **168**.

FIGS. **19** and **20** illustrate a sectional cover **172** configured to be disposed over, and selectively secured to, a sectional **174**. The sectional cover **172** may include magnetic fasteners **110** on a lower end to couple to magnetic components **78** of the sectional **174**. Handles **142** can be located near a lower end of the sectional cover **172**.

FIGS. **21** and **22** illustrate a smoker grill cover **176** configured to be disposed over, and selectively secured to, a smoker grill **178**. The smoker grill cover **176** may include magnetic fasteners **110** on a lower end to couple to magnetic components **78** of the smoker grill **178**. A hook-and-loop fastener **140** can be located on a bottom portion of the smoker grill cover **176** to provide additional securement of the smoker grill cover **176** to the smoker grill **178**. A handle **142** may be located on a top end of the smoker grill cover **176**.

FIGS. **23** and **24** illustrate an umbrella cover **180** configured to be disposed over, and selectively secured to, an umbrella **182**. The umbrella cover **180** may include magnetic fasteners **110** on a lower end to couple to magnetic components **78** of the umbrella **182**. A handle **142** can be located on a top end of the umbrella cover **180**.

FIGS. **25** and **26** illustrate a bench glider cover **184** configured to be disposed over, and selectively secured to, a bench glider **186**. The bench glider cover **184** includes magnetic fasteners **110** on a lower end to couple to magnetic components **78** of the bench glider **186**.

FIGS. **27** and **28** illustrate a bench cover **188** configured to be disposed over, and selectively secured to, a bench **190**. The bench cover **188** may include magnetic fasteners **110** on a lower end to couple to magnetic components **78** of the bench **190**.

FIGS. **29** and **30** illustrate a chair cover **192** configured to be disposed over, and selectively secured to, a chair **194**. The chair cover **192** may include magnetic fasteners **110** on a lower end to couple to magnetic components **78** of the chair **194**.

FIGS. **31** and **32** illustrate a chaise lounge cover **196** configured to be disposed over, and selectively secured to, a chaise lounge **198**. The chaise lounge cover **196** may include magnetic fasteners **110** on a lower end to couple to magnetic components **78** of the chaise lounge **198**.

FIGS. **33** and **34** illustrate a smoker grill cover **200** configured to be disposed over, and selectively secured to, a barrel grill **202**. The barrel grill cover **200** may include magnetic fasteners **110** on a lower end to couple to magnetic components **78** of the barrel grill **202**. A hook-and-loop fastener **140** can be located on a bottom portion of the barrel grill cover **200** to provide additional securement of the smoker grill cover **200** to the barrel grill **202**. A handle **142** may be located near a top end of the barrel grill cover **200**.

## Exemplary Materials and Methods of Manufacture

The materials used and methods of manufacturing various embodiments of the invention will now be discussed. It should be appreciated that any of various materials and methods of manufacture may be utilized in producing any of the various embodiments of the invention. Broadly, embodiments of the invention are directed to a method of manufacturing various outdoor equipment covers. The method may comprise steps of acquiring a polyester fabric; coating the polyester fabric with a protective coating; cutting the polyester fabric to a pattern shape; sewing the polyester fabric to form a cover body **80**; inserting a magnet **112** into a pocket; sealing the magnet **112***ic* component into the pocket; and securing the pocket to the cover body **80** to form the outdoor equipment cover.

In embodiments of the invention, the cover body **80** is formed of polyester fabric. Polyester fabric is formed at least partially of polyester yarns or fibers. Polyester is a synthetic, man-made polymer such as polyethylene terephthalate ("PET"). Polyester fabrics are typically durable and resistant, as well as strong yet lightweight. Polyester fabrics also have quick drying properties, which makes them ideal for outdoor applications. The pocket and the secondary fasteners **84** may additionally be formed at least partially of polyester fabric. The base, untreated polyester fabric may be referred to as greige. The polyester fabric may be provided in any of various grades, such as good, better, best, and premium.

In embodiments of the invention, the polyester material is coated so as to provide additional weatherproofing characteristics to the polyester material. The coated polyester material may be referred to as a vinyl coated polyester. The vinyl coated polyester includes the polyester fabric (the griege, which may also be referred to as a polyester scrim), a bonding or adhesive agent, and a polyvinyl chloride ("PVC") coating. The polyester material supports the coating. The PVC coating makes the polyester material waterproof and resistant to environmental factors. In other embodiments, the polyester material may be treated with another coating. Examples of the coating include polyester urethane ("PU"), polyether urethane ("PE"), and thermoplastic elastomer ("TPE") coatings. The coating is typically applied to the griege in a liquid form and allowed to cure.

The finished rolled vinyl coated polyester (or other finished rolled polyester fabric) is then cut and sewn. The rolled vinyl coated polyester is laid out on a cutting board and cut the patterns out for the specific outdoor equipment cover shape and size. Examples of outdoor equipment include the one depicted in FIGS. **1**, **2**, **5-34** and other outdoor equipment. Examples of outdoor equipment cover sizes include small ("S"), medium ("M"), large ("L"), extra-large ("XL").

The cut patterns are then sewn together. For example, the traversing segment is sewn to the anterior panel **86** and the posterior panel **88**. The additional items are also sewn to the cover body **80**. For example, the pocket may be sewn shut with the magnet **112** therein, and the facing **106** sewn to the pocket and the respective panel **86**, **88**, **90** of the cover body **80**. The cover, once sewn and put through a quality control process, is packed into the retail packaging.

## ADDITIONAL CONSIDERATIONS

In this description, references to "one embodiment," "an embodiment," or "embodiments" mean that the feature or features being referred to are included in at least one embodiment of the technology. Separate references to "one embodiment," "an embodiment," or "embodiments" in this description do not necessarily refer to the same embodiment and are also not mutually exclusive unless so stated and/or except as will be readily apparent to those skilled in the art from the description. For example, a feature, structure, act, etc. described in one embodiment may also be included in other embodiments, but is not necessarily included. Thus, the current technology can include a variety of combinations and/or integrations of the embodiments described herein.

Although the present application sets forth a detailed description of numerous different embodiments, it should be understood that the legal scope of the description is defined by the words of the claim(s) set forth at the end of this patent and equivalents. The detailed description is to be construed as exemplary only and does not describe every possible embodiment since describing every possible embodiment would be impractical. Numerous alternative embodiments may be implemented, using either current technology or technology developed after the filing date of this patent, which would still fall within the scope of the claims.

Throughout this specification, plural instances may implement components, operations, or structures described as a single instance. Although individual operations of one or more methods are illustrated and described as separate operations, one or more of the individual operations may be performed concurrently, and nothing requires that the operations be performed in the order illustrated. Structures and functionality presented as separate components in example configurations may be implemented as a combined structure or component. Similarly, structures and functionality presented as a single component may be implemented as separate components. These and other variations, modifications, additions, and improvements fall within the scope of the subject matter herein. The foregoing statements in the paragraph shall apply unless so stated in this description and/or except as will be readily apparent to those skilled in the art from the description.

As used herein, the terms "comprises," "comprising," "includes," "including," "has," "having" or any other variation thereof, are intended to cover a non-exclusive inclusion. For example, a process, method, article, or apparatus that comprises a list of elements is not necessarily limited to only those elements but may include other elements not expressly listed or inherent to such process, method, article, or apparatus.

What is claimed is:

**1**. An outdoor equipment cover configured to be utilized with an article of outdoor equipment having a metallic component, the outdoor equipment cover comprising:

a cover body presenting an outer edge disposed along a bottom side,

wherein the cover body presents a cover void therein configured to receive the outdoor equipment therein; and

a magnetic fastener having a bottom edge that is secured to the cover body proximate the bottom side of the outer edge such that the magnetic fastener is configured to pivot relative to the cover body about the bottom edge,

said magnetic fastener configured to provide a magnetic force to keep the magnetic fastener selectively secured to the metallic component of the outdoor equipment so as to keep the cover body in place around the outdoor equipment therein.

**2**. The outdoor equipment cover of claim **1**, wherein the magnetic fastener includes:

a pocket secured to the cover body; and

a magnet permanently disposed within the pocket.

**3**. The outdoor equipment cover of claim **2**, wherein the pocket is secured to the cover body by a seam along the outer edge of the cover body.

**4**. The outdoor equipment cover of claim **2**,

wherein the pocket is formed of a sheet that is distinct of the cover body,

wherein the pocket is sewn to the cover body via a facing.

**5**. The outdoor equipment cover of claim **1**,

wherein the magnetic fastener is a first magnetic fastener, the outdoor equipment cover further comprising:

a second magnetic fastener;

a third magnetic fastener; and

a fourth magnetic fastener.

**6**. The outdoor equipment cover of claim **5**,

wherein the cover body includes an anterior panel, a posterior panel, and a traversing panel,

wherein the first magnetic fastener and the second magnetic fastener are disposed on the anterior panel of the cover body,

wherein the third magnetic fastener and the fourth magnetic fastener are disposed on the posterior panel of the cover body.

**7**. The outdoor equipment cover of claim **5**,

wherein the metallic component of the outdoor equipment is a first metallic component,

wherein the first magnetic fastener and the second magnetic fastener are configured to secure to the first metallic component of the outdoor equipment,

wherein the outdoor equipment further includes a second metallic component,

wherein the third magnetic fastener and the fourth magnetic fastener are configured to secure to the second metallic component of the outdoor equipment.

**8**. The outdoor equipment cover of claim **1**, wherein the magnetic fastener is a first magnetic fastener, the outdoor equipment cover further comprising a second magnetic fastener.

**9**. The outdoor equipment cover of claim **1**, wherein the outdoor equipment comprises one of a griddle cover, a kettle grill, a chair, a table, a smoker, a fire pit, a sectional, a smoker grill, an umbrella, a bench glider, a bench, a chair, a chaise lounge, or a barrel grill.

**10**. An outdoor equipment cover configured to be utilized with an article of outdoor equipment having a metallic component, the outdoor equipment cover comprising:

a cover body presenting an outer edge disposed along a bottom side, wherein the cover body presents a cover void therein configured to receive the outdoor equipment therein;

a magnetic fastener secured to the cover body, the magnetic fastener comprising a pocket and a magnet disposed within the pocket,

said magnetic fastener configured to provide a magnetic force to keep the magnetic fastener selectively secured to the metallic component of the outdoor equipment so as to keep the cover body in place around the outdoor equipment therein;

a facing along the outer edge, wherein the pocket is secured to the cover body by the facing; and

a secondary fastener secured to the cover body,

said secondary fastener configured to reduce a cross-sectional area of the cover void so as to prevent the outdoor equipment cover from being removed from the outdoor equipment while the secondary fastener is emplaced.

**11**. The outdoor equipment cover of claim **10**, wherein the outdoor equipment comprises one of a griddle cover, a kettle grill, a chair, a table, a smoker, a fire pit, a sectional, a smoker grill, an umbrella, a bench glider, a bench, a chair, a chaise lounge, or a barrel grill.

**12**. The outdoor equipment cover of claim **10**, wherein the pocket is secured to the cover body by a seam along the outer edge of the cover body.

**13**. The outdoor equipment cover of claim **10**, wherein the pocket is pivotable about the facing relative to the cover body.

**14**. The outdoor equipment cover of claim **10**, wherein the pocket is formed of a sheet that is distinct of the cover body.

**15**. The outdoor equipment cover of claim **10**, wherein the secondary fastener includes:

an anterior strap; and

a posterior strap.

**16**. The outdoor equipment cover of claim **15**, wherein the secondary fastener includes a hook-and-loop fastener configured to securely hold the anterior strap to the posterior strap.

**17**. The outdoor equipment cover of claim **10**, wherein the cover body comprises a polyester fabric having a protective coating.

**18**. The outdoor equipment cover of claim **17**, wherein the protective coating applied to the polyester fabric is a PVC coating.

**19**. The outdoor equipment cover of claim **10** wherein the outdoor equipment cover also comprises a handle.

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